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Test - 13

Medieval History

Topics covered:

- Pallavas & Chalukyas in South, Chola Empire (9th-12th century)
- Ghaznavid and Turkish Invasions Delhi Sultanate (1200-1400 CE)
- Vijayanagar and Bahmani Kingdom
- Mughal Empire, Rise of Marathas
- Current Affairs June 2021



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6. Penalty for wrong answers:

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- I. There are four alternatives for the answer to every question. For each question for which a wrong answer has been given by the candidate, One-Third of the marks assigned to that question will be deducted as penalty.
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TOPICS COVERD: Pallavas & Chalukyas in South, Chola Empire (9th-12th century), Ghaznavid and Turkish Invasions Delhi Sultanate (1200-1400 CE), Vijayanagara and Bahmini Kingdom, Mughal Empire, Rise of Marathas, Current Affairs June 2021



Q.1) With reference to Indian history, consider the following pairs:

Personality	Association
1. Charaka	Rule of Kanishka
2. Kalidasa	Rule of Chandragupta-II
3. Brahmagupta	Rule of Skandagupta

Which of the pairs given above is/are correctly matched?

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 2 and 3 only
- c) 1 and 3 only
- d) 1, 2 and 3

Q.2) Consider the following statements about the Mauryan and Gupta administration:

- 1. The Mauryan administration was centralized whereas the Gupta administration was decentralised.
- 2. The Guptas had a larger bureaucracy than the Mauryas due to the complexities of their administration.
- 3. Unlike the Mauryan bureaucracy, the Gupta bureaucracy had hereditary nature.

Which of the statements given above is/ are correct?

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 2 and 3 only
- c) 1 and 3 only
- d) 1, 2 and 3

Q.3) Consider the following statements about Ashokan inscriptions:

- 1. All the minor rock edicts call Ashoka by the name 'Devanampiya piyadasi', except the one at Maski.
- 2. The Rummindei pillar inscription informs about the visit of Ashoka to Lumbini and reduction of royal tax to one-eighth.
- 3. In the larger part of the subcontinent the Ashokan inscriptions have been written in Brahmi script.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 2 and 3 only
- c) 1 and 3 only
- d) 1, 2 and 3

Q.4) Consider the following statements about the Hinayana and Mahayana form of Buddhism:

- 1. Buddhism was divided into Hinayana and Mahayana in the third Buddhist council.
- 2. The Hinayana Buddhists treated Buddha as a guide, while Mahayana Buddhists worship Buddha in the form of an idol.

3. The most important work of Hinayana is the Mahavastu while the Lalitavistara is the most sacred Mahayana text.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 2 and 3 only
- c) 1 and 3 only
- d) 1, 2 and 3

Q.5) Consider the following statements about the rule of Kushana:

- 1. They issued gold coins with a higher degree of metallic purity than those issued by the Guptas.
- 2. They were the first rulers in India to issue coins which can be definitely attributed to the kings.
- 3. They portrayed a king on the obverse and a deity on the reverse side of a coin.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 2 and 3 only
- c) 1 and 3 only
- d) 1, 2 and 3

Q.6) Consider the following statements about the Satavahanas:

- 1. They continued the administrative pattern of the Mauryas.
- 2. They were the first rulers to make tax free land grants for religious merit.
- 3. Kalyani was an important port on the west coast during this period.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 2 and 3 only
- c) 1 and 3 only
- d) 1, 2 and 3

Q.7) Which of the following statements about Sangam age is incorrect?

- a) They had trade relations with Romans and exported perfumes, jewels, ivory and diamonds to them.
- b) The Brahmins enjoyed no special privilege in the society.
- c) The condition of women was better than in north India and there was absence of child marriage and sati.
- d) None of the above

Q.8) Consider the following statements about the Indus Valley Civilisation and Vedic Period:



1. Indus Valley people were icon-worshippers, whereas people of Vedic period were opposed to icon-worship.
2. The people of both Indus Valley Civilisation and Vedic period were unaware about the use of iron.
3. The people of Vedic period had high regard for cows, which was not the case with the people of the Indus Valley Civilisation.

Which of the statements given above is/ are correct?

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 2 and 3 only
- c) 1 and 3 only
- d) 1, 2 and 3

Q.9) With reference to the Indian history, which of the following statements is incorrect?

- a) The Harappan writing was boustrophedon.
- b) The Buddhist text Anguttara Nikaya mentions the sixteen Mahajanapadas.
- c) Devichandraguptam is a political drama and narrates the ascent of king Chandragupta Maurya to power.
- d) None of the above

Q.10) Consider the following statements with reference to Vedic period:

1. The purpose of worship of Vedic period people was materialistic and not spiritual.
2. The Ashram system is first mentioned in the Aitareya Brahmana.
3. In the Rig Vedic period there was no regular taxation.

Which of the statements given above is/ are correct?

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 2 and 3 only
- c) 1 and 3 only
- d) 1, 2 and 3

Q.11) Consider the following pairs:

- | Text | Author |
|---------------------------|-------------|
| 1) <i>Visuddhimagga</i> - | Ashvagoshha |
| 2) <i>Budhacharitra</i> - | Vasumitra |
| 3) <i>Rajatarangini</i> - | Kalhan |

Which of the above pairs is/are correctly matched?

- a) 1 only
- b) 3 only
- c) 2 and 3 only
- d) 1 and 3 only

Q.12) Consider the following statements regarding ancient Indian inscriptions:

- 1) The *Kalsi* inscription gives an account of the Ashokan administration post his conversion to Buddhism.
- 2) The name *Ashoka* is mentioned in the Kanaganahalli inscription.
- 3) The Dhamek stupa is situated near the site of Dharmachakrapravartana.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 2 and 3 only
- c) 1 and 3 only
- d) 1, 2, and 3

Q.13) In the context of the Pala rule in India, consider the following statements:

- 1) The Pala rulers of Bengal followed Hinayana Buddhism.
- 2) Universities at Vikramshila and Odantapuri were built under Pala rulers.
- 3) The Pala rulers were mainly Buddhist and did not build Hindu temples.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 2 only
- c) 1 and 3 only
- d) 3 only

Q.14) With reference to the development of sculptural art during ancient India, Consider the following statements:

- 1) The red sandstone was used in the Mathura school.
- 2) Buddha is depicted in the spiritual state in the Indo-Greek art.
- 3) Amravati school of art was patronized by the Kakatiya rulers.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- a) 1 and 3 only
- b) 2 only
- c) 1 and 2 only
- d) 3 only

Q.15) Which of the following foreign travellers visited Nalanda university?

1. Fa hien
2. I-Tsing
3. Ibn Batuta
4. Huen Tsang

Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 2 and 4 only



- c) 1, 2, and 4 only
- d) 1, 3 and 4 only

Q.16) Consider the following pairs:

Famous Universities Associated Kings

- | | | |
|----------------|---|-----------------------|
| 1. Vikramshila | - | Gopala I |
| 2. Manyakheta | - | Gautamiputra Satkarni |
| 3. Nalanda | - | Dharampala |

Select the correctly matched pairs using the codes given below:

- a) 1 only
- b) 3 only
- c) 2 and 3 only
- d) None of the above

Q.17) With reference to the shreni or guilds system of ancient India, Consider the following statements.

- 1. The king had central administrative authority over all the shrenis registered with the state.
- 2. Shrenis also served as a bank for merchants in which only rich male merchants could deposit their money.
- 3. The Shrenis had Executive, Regulatory and judicial power over its own members.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 and 2
- b) 2 and 3
- c) 1 and 3
- d) 1, 2 and 3

Q.18) With reference to the ancient history, consider the following:

Archaeological site Present state

- | | | |
|--------------|---|------------------|
| 1. Chirand | - | Uttar Pradesh |
| 2. Koldihawa | - | Bihar |
| 3. Burzahom | - | Himachal Pradesh |
| 4. Gufkra | - | Jammu Kashmir |

Which of the pairs given above is/are incorrect?

- a) 2, 3 and 4 only
- b) 1, 2 and 3 only
- c) 1, 3 and 4 only
- d) 1, 2, 3 and 4

Q.19) Consider the following statements about the Tamil Kingdoms:

- 1. Unlike the Cholas, the Pandyas couldn't realise substantial revenue from agriculture as well as from trade.

- 2. The expedition of Malik Kafur happened during the chola rule
- 3. Village assemblies under the Chola collected a tax called eriyam, for the maintenance of learning institutions.

Which of the statements given above is/are not correct?

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 2 and 3 only
- c) 1 and 3 only
- d) 1, 2 and 3 only

Q.20) Consider the following statements about the art and architecture of the southern dynasties:

- 1. The Nagara style of art and architecture reached its perfection under the Cholas.
- 2. The monolithic rathas and the Mandapas found at Mamallapuram are notable architecture of the Cheras.
- 3. Absence of Rock cut architecture is a notable feature of the Pandyan rule.

Which of the statements given above is/are Incorrect?

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 1 and 3 only
- c) 2 and 3 only
- d) 1, 2 and 3 only

Q.21) With reference to the history of ancient India, consider the following statements:

- 1) Rajendra, I defeated the Kalabhras and firmly established the Pallava rule in Tondaimandalam.
- 2) Bharavi, the great poet who wrote the famous Kiratrjuniya, was patronized by pallavas.

Which of the statements given above is/ are correct?

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 only
- c) Both 1 and 2
- d) Neither 1 nor 2

Q.22) With reference to the art and culture of the Chola's, consider the following statements :

- 1) Dravidian school of temple building reached its climax and temples became important centres of life in the villages.
- 2) Sculpture making by use of bronze-casting started by the Chola's during the middle of 9th century.
- 3) Shiva in his abode kailasa as Nataraja is one of the finest examples of Chola paintings.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 and 2 only



- b) 2 only
- c) 1 and 3 only
- d) 1, 2 and 3

Q.23) With reference to the taxation system of the Chola's, consider the following statements:

- 1) Scientific tax assessment with the help of surveys was done by a land revenue department.
- 2) There was detailed differentiation between the central taxes and local cesses.
- 3) Land taxes were standardized along with a number of other taxes related to land.
- 4) Prevalence of local forms of collection of tax and reinvestment of such in local avenues.

Which of the given statements above is/are correct?

- a) 1, 2 and 3 only
- b) 1, 2 and 4 only
- c) 3 only
- d) 1, 2, 3 and 4

Q.24) With respect to the Pallava kingdom, match the following lists:

<u>List-I (Kings)</u>	<u>List-II</u>
(Contributions)	
1) Simhavishnu	A. Follower of Vaishnavism.
2) Mahendravarman I	B. Construction of Shore temples of Mahabalipuram.
3) Narasimhavarman I	C. Defeated by Pulakesin II of the Chalukyas.
4) Narasimhavarman II	D. Assumed the title of 'Vatapikonda'.
5) Nandivarman II	E. Construction of Vaikuntaperumal temple of Kanchi.

Select the answer from the codes given below:

- a) 1- A, 2- C, 3- D, 4- B, 5- E
- b) 1- A, 2- B, 3- D, 4- C, 5- E
- c) 1- D, 2- A, 3- B, 4- E, 5- C
- d) 1- D, 2- E, 3- B, 4- A, 5- C

Q.25) With reference to the development of literature during the Pallavas, which of the following statements is/are true ?

- 1) Kiratarjuniyam and Dasakumaracharitam were the famous literary works compiled during the Pallavas' rule.
- 2) Mahendravarman I was famous for burlesque writing.
- 3) Pattadakal, was a famous site for Sanskrit learning.

Select the correct answer using the codes given below.

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 1 only
- c) 2 and 3 only
- d) 1, 2 and 3

Q.26) With respect to the administration of the Chalukyas, consider the following statements :

- 1) Central government under the Chalukyas maintained a paternalistic control over the village administration without any autonomy to village administration.
- 2) The Chalukyas had a small standing army with great maritime power.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 only
- c) Both 1 and 2
- d) Neither 1 nor 2

Q.27) Match the following lists, regarding the kings of the Chalukyan period and their achievements.

<u>List-I.</u>	<u>List -II.</u>
1) Pulakesin I	A. Repelling the Arab invasion.
2) Kirtivarman I	B. Founder of the Chalukya dynasty.
3) Vikramaditya I	C. Plundered Kanchi, the Pallava capital.
4) Vikramaditya II	D. Defeated the Nalas of Bastar
5) Kirtivarman II	E. Last Chalukya ruler who was defeated by Dantidurga.

Select the correct answer from the codes given below.

- a) 1- B, 2- D, 3- C, 4- A, 5- E.
- b) 1- B, 2- C, 3- D, 4- E, 5- A.
- c) 1- C, 2- B, 3- D, 4- A, 5- E.
- d) 1- C, 2- D, 3- B, 4- E, 5- A.

Q.28) Which of the following temples is/are associated with the Chalukyas ?

- 1) Melagitti Sivalaya
- 2) Hucimaligudi
- 3) Meguti
- 4) Ladh Khan
- 5) Papanatha
- 6) Virupaksha
- 7) Anantesvara

Select the answer using the codes given below.



- a) 1, 2, 3, 4, 5 and 6 only
- b) 2, 3, 4, 5, and 7 only
- c) 1, 5, 6 and 7 only
- d) 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6 and 7

Q.29) In the context of Chalukyan kingdom, consider the following statements:

- 1) The Chalukya administration was highly decentralized unlike that of the Pallavas and the Cholas.
- 2) The Ashwamedha sacrifice ritual was practiced by some Chalukyan rulers.
- 3) The Aihole inscription is related to the Chalukya Kingdom.

Which of the statements given above is/ are correct?

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 2 and 3 only
- c) 1 and 3 only
- d) 1, 2 and 3 only

Q.30) With reference to the land gifts given by the the Chola kings, Consider the following statements:

- 1) Vellanvagai refers to the land grants given to the Brahmanas.
- 2) Tirunamattukkani was land given for non-Brahmana peasant proprietors.
- 3) Pallichchandam were land donated to Jaina institutions

Which of the statements given above is/are not correct?

- a) 1 and 3 Only
- b) 1 and 2 Only
- c) 3 only
- d) 1, 2 and 3

Q.31) Match the following names of the cities in India around 1200 AD to that of the present day names :

<u>List -I (Ancient Name)</u>		<u>List -II(Present day Name)</u>
1) Shakambhari town (Rajasthan)	-	A. Sambhar Lake
2) Ajayameru	-	B. Ajmer(Rajasthan)
3) Mankhet Malkhed(Karnataka)	-	C.
4) Kanyakubja Pradesh)	-	D. Kannauj(Uttar Pradesh)
5) Kalyani district(Karnataka)	-	E. Bidar

Select the correct answer using the codes given below.

- a) 1- A, 2- B, 3- C, 4- D, 5- E
- b) 1- A, 2- B, 3- D, 4- C, 5- E
- c) 1- E, 2- D, 3- A, 4- C, 5- B
- d) 1- D, 2- E, 3- A, 4- C, 5- B

Q.32) With reference to the Ghaznavids, the term 'Shikan' meant:

- a) Destroyer of images for protection of Islam.
- b) An empire that included Syria, Iran and Trans-Oxiana.
- c) Central Asian tribal Turkish invaders.
- d) Rules and regulations framed by the Sultan

Q.33) With reference to Mahmud of Ghazni's repeated invasions to India, consider the following statements.

- 1) His first ever invasion in India was marked by the capture of the forts of Lamghan (Afghanistan) that subsequently stretched to as far as Saurashtra in his later invasions.
- 2) Mahmud's Indian campaigns began during the dry seasons and ended before the monsoons.
- 3) The Hindushahi rulers were the first to offer resistance to the Ghaznavids while entering India.
- 4) He applied the policy of truce with the Muslim rulers that came in his way of plundering India.

Which of the above given statements is/are true ?

- a) 1, 2 and 3 only
- b) 1 only
- c) 2, 3 and 4 only
- d) 1, 2, 3 and 4

Q.34) Which of the following statements is/are correct regarding Mahmud of Ghazni ?

- 1) He became symbolic in cultural politics due to his fame for his pillage, plunder and murder of heretics and infidels.
- 2) His fanaticism was not confined to non-muslims and attacked muslim heretics with equal ferocity.
- 3) Mahmud was generous to learned men and bestowed them with gifts and wealth.

Select the answer from the codes given below.

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 1 only
- c) 2 and 3 only
- d) 1, 2 and 3

Q.35) Which of the following factors lead to Mahmud of Ghazni invading India multiple times ?

- 1) Absence of any formidable kingdom in North India to provide resistance.



- 2) Mahmud's plundering activities did not reach far south and confined around the North and parts of Western India only.

Which of the above given statements is/are correct ?

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 only
- c) Both 1 and 2
- d) Neither 1 nor 2

Q.36) In the context of medieval Indian history, what is the meaning of the term ' Khokhar '?

- a) Land revenue policies for the conquered lands.
- b) Plundered war booty collected after the raids on Indian rulers.
- c) A particular tribe living in the area near modern Punjab.
- d) Type of foreign literature brought by the Ghaznavids.

Q.37) With respect to the Delhi Sultanate, consider the following statements:

- 1) The death of Muhammad Ghori resulted in the formation of Delhi Sultanate.
- 2) The Delhi Sultanate was ruled by five dynasties of Turkish origin.

Which of the above statements is /are incorrect?

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 only
- c) Both 1 and 2
- d) Neither 1 nor 2

Q.38) With reference to the Delhi Sultanate, which of the following statements is/are correct about Ghiyasuddin Balban?

- 1) He set about a policy of liquidation of the chalisa or group of 40 nobles.
- 2) Prevalence of equality in the matter of administration of justice during his reign.
- 3) Balban went on frequent conquests outside Delhi to expand his empire.

Select the correct answer using the codes given below.

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 3 only
- c) 1 and 3 only
- d) 1, 2 and 3

Q.39) With reference to the Delhi Sultanate, which of the following statements is/are correct about Feroz Shah Tughlaq?

- 1) Iqtadari system was abolished by him.

- 2) He established Diwan-i-amir-kohi for the development and upgradation of agricultural methods.
- 3) He imposed the Jizya on the Brahmins for the first time.
- 4) Bengal became independent from the Delhi Sultanate during his reign.

Select the correct answer using the codes given below.

- a) 2, 3 and 4 only
- b) 2 only
- c) 1, 2 and 3 only
- d) 3 and 4 only

Q.40) With reference to various institutions and their functions during the Delhi Sultanate, match List-I and List-II.

<u>List-I(Institutions)</u>	<u>List-II(Functions)</u>
1. Diwan-i-Arz	- A. Department of slave
2. Diwan-i-Rasalat Department	- B. Military
3. Diwan-i-Bandagan	- C. Department of records and correspondence.
4. Diwan-i-Wizarat	- D. Department of religious affairs
5. Diwan-i-kohi department	- E. Finance
6. Diwan-i-insha	- F. Department of agriculture.

Select the answer using the codes given below:

- a) 1-B, 2-D, 3-A, 4-E, 5-F, 6-C
- b) 1-B, 2-D, 3-E, 4-A, 5-F, 6-C
- c) 1-A, 2-F, 3-C, 4-D, 5-E, 6-B
- d) 1-A, 2-C, 3-F, 4-D, 5-E, 6-B

Q.41) With reference to the various measures taken by Allauddin Khilji to control the markets and introduction of agrarian policies to increase land revenue, which of the following statements is/are correct ?

- 1) He sought to fix the cost of all commodities available in the market.
- 2) Alauddin appointed a high official called Shahna to maintain the register of the merchants and control the prices in the market.
- 3) For better collection of land revenue, the villages were assigned to iqtadars.

Select the answer using the codes given below:



- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 2 and 3 only
- c) 1, 2 and 3
- d) 2 only

Q.42) Consider the following statements:

1. The Battle of Waihind was fought between the Anandapala and Mahmud Ghori in Kannauj.
 2. Mathura, Kannauj, Gujarat, Thaneshwar were raided by Mahmud of Ghazni.
 3. The decline of the Hindu Shahi kingdom occurred due to the invasion of Mahmud of Ghazni.
- Which of the statements given above is/are correct?**

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 2 and 3 only
- c) 1 and 3 only
- d) 1, 2, and 3

Q.43) Consider the following statements:

1. The rule of Delhi Sultanate extended till Madurai during the reign of Alauddin Khilji.
2. Maduravijyam gives an account of the conquest of Madurai by Malik Kafur.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 only
- c) Both 1 and 2
- d) Neither 1 nor 2

Q.44) Which of the following travellers visited Vijayanagar Kingdom during the reign of Devraya I?

- 1) Nicolo Conti
- 2) Domingo Paes
- 3) Fernao Nuniz
- 4) Abdur Razzaq

Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

- a) 1 and only
- b) 1 only
- c) 1, 2 and 3 only
- d) 2 and 4 only

Q.45) With reference to the temple architecture of Vijayanagar and Hoysala school, which of the following statements is/are incorrect?

- 1) Multiple shrines around a central pillar hall were found in Hoysala architecture whereas Multiple Mandap was a feature of Vijayanagar architecture.
- 2) The elephant was the most common animal found on the pillars of Vijayanagara temples.

- 3) Chennakesava temple in Belur is an example of Vijayanagara Architecture.

Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

- a) 2 only
- b) 2 and 3 only
- c) 1 and 3 only
- d) 3 only

Q.46) He encouraged the pursuit of astronomy and built an observatory near Daulatabad. He paid much attention to the principal ports of his Kingdom. Moreover he wanted to make Deccan the Cultural centre of India and he was well acquainted with natural science such as botany, geometry. Who is being referred to in the above passage?

- a) Hasan Gangu
- b) Alam Shah
- c) Firuz Shah
- d) Mahmud Gawan

Q.47) With reference to the history of Vijaynagar kingdom, consider the following statements:

- 1) The governors completely depended on the central authority to carry out the administration.
- 2) The foreign travellers had given an elaborate account about village life and tax on peasants.

Which of the statements given above is/are incorrect?

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 only
- c) Both 1 and 2
- d) Neither 1 nor 2

Q.48) Which of the following statements about administration and justice in Vijaynagar Kingdom is correct?

- 1) Village self Government was a prominent feature of Vijayanagar rule.
 - 2) Harsh punishments were inflicted as Dharmasastras formed the basis of justice in the Kingdom.
 - 3) The king was the highest court of appeal.
- Select the correct answer from the code given below:**
- a) 1 and 2 only
 - b) 2 and 3 only
 - c) 1 and 3 only
 - d) All of the above

Q.49) Which of the following statements about the Vijayanagar kingdom is incorrect?



- 1) Land revenue gifts from feudal chiefs and customs duties were major source of revenue in Vijayanagar kingdom
- 2) The expenditure of the state was divided into two parts-personal expenditures of the king and military conquests.
- 3) The Sangama Rulers were chiefly Vaishnavite.

Select the answer from the code given below:

- a) 3 only
- b) 1 and 3 only
- c) 2 and 3 only
- d) 2 only

Q.50) With reference to Vijaynagar kingdom, which of the following pairs are correctly matched?

- | Terms | Meaning |
|------------|-------------------------------------|
| 1) Nayaks | - Top Grade Officers of the Revenue |
| 2) Amarams | - Military Grants |
| 3) Varaha | - Gold Coins |

Select the answer using the codes given below:

- a) 2 only
- b) 1 and 2 only
- c) 1 and 3 only
- d) 2 and 3 only

Q.51) Many travellers have provided vivid accounts of Vijayanagar Kingdom. In this regard, Consider the following travellers:

- 1) Fernao Nuniz
- 2) Domingo Paes
- 3) Duarte Barbosa

Which of the above travellers were from Portugal?

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 2 and 3 only
- c) All of the above
- d) 1 and 3 only

Q.52) With reference to the scholars/litterateurs of vijaynagar Kingdom,consider the following statements:

- 1) Srinatha is associated with Krishna Deva raya.
- 2) Madhura is associated with Deva raya I.
- 3) Allasani Peddana is associated with Achyut Deva Raya.

Which of the statements given above is/are incorrect:

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 1 and 3 only
- c) 2 and 3 only
- d) All of the above

Q.53) Consider the following foreign travellers who visited India:

- 1) Ibn Battuta
- 2) Domingo paes
- 3) Nuniz
- 4) Nicolo Conti

What is the correct chronological order of their visits to India, starting from the earliest time ?

- a) 1-4-3-2
- b) 1-4-2-3
- c) 4-1-3-2
- d) 4-1-2-3

Q.54) Consider the following statements about medieval India:

- 1) Bhagya Nagar was founded by Mohammed quli Qutub Shah
- 2) Gol Gumbaz was built by Mohammed Adil Shah and is built with red marble.

Which of the statements given above is/ are correct?

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 only
- c) Both 1 and 2
- d) Neither 1 nor 2

Q.55) Consider the following statements:

- 1) *Ashtadiggajas* were associated with the Tuluva dynasty while the *Ashtapradhan* were related to the Marathas.
- 2) The Battle of Talikota was fought between Krishnadeva Raya and the combined army of Bijapur, Ahmadnagar, Golconda, and Bidar.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 only
- c) Both 1 and 2
- d) Neither 1 nor 2

Q.56) Consider the following statements with respect to Vijayanagara Kingdom:

- 1) Virupaksha Temple, a UNESCO World Heritage Site, located on banks of River Tungabhadra, was built under Krishnadeva Raya.
- 2) Raichur Doab, a triangular region of fertile land, between Krishna and Godavari, was hotly contested between Vijayanagar and Bahmani kingdom.
- 3) The Deva Raya II of the Sangama dynasty, decisively defeated Bahmani Sultans in Battle of Diwani.



- 4) Horse was the most common animal found in pillars of Vijayanagara temples.
- 5) Krishnadeva Raya was a proficient Sanskrit litterateur

Which of the following statements are incorrect?

- a) 3 and 5 only
- b) 1 and 4 only
- c) 1, 2, and 3 only
- d) 4 and 5 only

Q.57) Which of the following statements is *least* appropriate with reference to the Bahmani kingdom?

- a) The founder of the kingdom was Zafar Khan, a noble under Mohammad Bin Tughlaq.
- b) The capital was shifted from Gulbarga to Bidar.
- c) The kingdom reached its peak under the rule of Mahmud Gawan.
- d) Development of Persian style of architecture, which was later used by Deccan sultanates too.

Q.58) Which of the following statements is/are correct regarding Babur?

- 1) He was a follower of Naqshbandiya Sufi Khwaja Ubaidullah Ahrar.
- 2) He wrote his memoir Baburnama in Persian.
- 3) He introduced the Charbagh pattern

Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 only
- c) 2 and 3 only
- d) 1 and 3 only

Q.59) With reference to Mansabdari system and Jagirdari system of Land Revenue Administration during Mughal period, Consider the following statements:

- 1) The rank in Mansabdari system wasn't hereditary but princes of royal blood received higher ranks
- 2) All appointments, promotion as well as dismissals were directly made by the Mughal Emperor
- 3) In Jagirdari system, out of various types of Jagirs, Watan Jagirs were hereditary but non-transferable

Which of the statements given above is/are Incorrect?

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 2 only
- c) 3 only
- d) None of the above

Q.60) With reference to Land Revenue policy in Mughal period, Consider the following statements:

- 1) Raja Todar Mal introduced the uniform system of land measurement while Akbar introduced the Dahsala System.
- 2) Land was divided into four categories of which Parati and Banjar land were assessed at concessional rates.
- 3) Khudkasht was the term used for peasants who tilled rented lands.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 only
- b) 3 only
- c) 2 and 3 only
- d) 1, 2 and 3

Q.61) With reference to Mughal Administration, Consider the following statements:

- 1) The administration was centralised and territories were tri-divided into Jagir, Khalisa and Inam.
- 2) The emperor had all military as well as Judicial powers
- 3) Akbar took away the financial power from Wazir

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 2 and 3 only
- c) 1 and 3 only
- d) 1, 2 and 3

Q.62) Consider the following statements:

1. Akbar built the Panch Mahal (Fatehpura Sikri) which was built according to Hindu design based on Man Mandir
2. Akbar built the Buland darwaza to commemorate the victory over Bengal
3. Despite the subjugation of Rajasthan, there was no hostilities between Rajputs and Mughals

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 3 only
- c) 1 and 3 only
- d) 1 only

Q.63) With reference to social stratification during later medieval period, consider the following statements:

1. During Mughal times, the term '*Pahi Kashta*' was used for peasants who were residents of the village in which they held their lands.



2. The Iqta Assignments of land given to military commanders to support them, during Akbar, was adopted from the Turks or Turkish Method

Which of the Statements given above is/are correct ?

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 only
- c) Both 1 and 2
- d) Neither 1 nor 2

Q.64) Consider the following statements with reference to Marathas :

- 1. In the Maratha provincial Administration, Deshmukhs and Deshpande were two officers at two different levels of administration.
- 2. Shivaji reduced the power of Deshmukhs and appointed his own revenue official called Karkuns.
- 3. In Shivaji's administration, Modi script was the name given to special script used in revenue records

Which of the Statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 2 and 3 only
- c) 1 and 3 only
- d) 1, 2 and 3

Q.65) Which of the following statements is/are correct regarding Babur?

- 1. He was a follower of Naqshbandiya Sufi Khwaja Ubaidullah Ahrar.
- 2. He wrote his memoir Baburnama in Persian.
- 3. He introduced the Charbagh pattern

Which of the Statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 only
- c) 2 and 3 only
- d) 1 and 3 only

Q.66) With reference to the position of women during Mughal Period, Consider the following statements statements :

- 1. In South India and Hindu Middle class, people didn't adopt the purdah system.
- 2. Akbar had issued orders in favour of polygamy which was a privilege of the rich

Which of the above statements is/are correct ?

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 only
- c) Both 1 and 2
- d) Neither 1 nor 2

Q.67) With reference to Sher Shah, consider the following statements :

- 1. He was intolerant towards other religions and preferred to employ muslim in important offices
- 2. He introduced the tri-coinage system also known as system of tri-metalism
- 3. He built the Rohtas fort in Bihar which is now a UNESCO World Heritage Site

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 2 only
- c) 3 only
- d) 1 and 3 only

Q.68) With reference to Administration of Sher Shah Suri, Consider the following statements:

- 1. Government was highly centralised and consisted of several departments.
- 2. He classified land and Land revenue was assessed every year.
- 3. Under Sher Shah Suri, the share of state was one-third of the average produce which was to be paid in Silver Rupaiya.

Which of the Statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 & 2 only
- b) 2 & 3 only
- c) 1 & 3 only
- d) None of the above

Q.69) With reference to the Society during Medieval Period, consider the following Statements :

- 1. In Medieval Indian society, Hindu were referred to as Gentoos in English documents.
- 2. During Mughals, there was no bar to inter-marriages on racial grounds in Muslim society.
- 3. Muslim society had more internal mobility than their counterpart, Hindu society.

Which of the above statements is/are correct ?

- a) 1 and 2
- b) 3 only
- c) 1, 2 and 3
- d) None of the above

Q.70) Consider the following statements with reference to Mughal Provincial administration :

- 1. Fauzdar & Shiqdar were two officials in different departments in different levels of provincial hierarchy.
- 2. The port Administration under Akbar was independent of Provincial Authority.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct ?



- a) 1 only
- b) 2 only
- c) Both 1 and 2
- d) Neither 1 nor 2

Q.71) "Desertification and Land Degradation Atlas of India" is published by -

- a) Ministry of Earth Science
- b) Indian Space Research Organisation
- c) Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change
- d) Ministry of Agriculture

Q.72) "G-33" sometimes seen in news is related to -

- a) Group of developing countries advocating for nuclear disarmament at the United Nations.
- b) Group of developing countries fighting for Trade Related Aspects of Intellectual Property Rights (TRIPS) waiver at World Trade Organization (WTO).
- c) Group of developing countries negotiating for agricultural trade and tariff exemptions at the World Trade Organization.
- d) Group of developing countries working towards major issues related to the global economy.

Q.73) PENCIL Platform recently seen in news is for the eradication of -

- a) Child Labour
- b) Illiteracy
- c) Domestic violence
- d) Poverty

Q.74) The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) recently published the Future Expectations Index (FEI) and Current Situation Index (CSI), these reports are related to which of the following?

- a) Inflation
- b) Fiscal Deficit
- c) Non-Performing Assets
- d) Consumer Sentiments

Q.75) Consider the following statements with reference to EnVision Mission:

1. EnVision Mission is a NASA led mission to Venus to study the atmosphere of the planet.
2. It is the first ever mission to study the planet, Venus.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 only
- c) Both 1 and 2

- d) Neither 1 nor 2

Q.76) Consider the following statements with reference to Tulu language:

1. Tulu is a Dravidian language spoken mainly in coastal districts of Tamil Nadu and Andhra Pradesh.
2. Recently, Tulu language got recognition from the Sahitya Akademi.
3. As per the New Education Policy 2020 Tulu can be selected as a third option language in Class 10 examination.

Which of the statements given above is/are incorrect?

- a) 1 and 3 only
- b) 1 and 2 only
- c) 2 and 3 only
- d) 1, 2 and 3

Q.77) India launched 'Industrial Deep Decarbonization Initiative' to promote industrial energy efficiency in partnership with which one of the following countries?

- a) United Arab Emirates
- b) United Kingdom
- c) United States of America
- d) France

Q.78) Identify the correct increasing order according to their weights of the components given below for the calculation of Purchasing Managers Index in India.

1. Output
2. Employment
3. New order
4. Stock of items purchased
5. Supplier delivery times.

Select the correct answer from the codes given below:

- a) 4- 5- 2- 1- 3
- b) 3- 2- 1- 5- 4
- c) 5- 4- 2- 1 -3
- d) 5- 2- 1- 4- 3

Q.79) Consider the following statements with reference to "India Cycles4Change Challenge:

1. The Ministry of Environment Forest and Climate Change curated this challenge under the Atmanirbhar Bharat Abhiyan.
2. The challenge envisaged cycling as an important mode of safe and healthy personal transport



medium that ensures social distancing, while being environmentally sustainable.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 only
- c) Both 1 and 2
- d) Neither 1 nor 2

Q.80) Which of the following statements is incorrect with reference to SDG India Index ?

- a) The third edition of the SDG India Index and Dashboard 2020–21 was released by NITI Aayog.
- b) The SDG India Index 2020–21 is developed in collaboration with the World Bank.
- c) The Index tracks progress of all States and UTs on 115 indicators that are aligned to MoSPI's National Indicator Framework (NIF).
- d) There are no states in the "Achievers" category in the index released.

Q.81) "Glaciers of the Himalayas: Climate Change, Black Carbon and Regional Resilience" report is released by -

- a) World Bank
- b) United Nations Environment Programme
- c) Ministry of Environment Forest and Climate Change
- d) NITI Aayog in association with Global Environment Facility.

Q.82) INSACOG, sometimes recently in news is related to -

- a) It is a new type of warship inducted by the Indian Coast Guard.
- b) It is a national multi-agency consortium of Genome Sequencing Laboratories.
- c) A type of Genetically Modified Organisms to combat pollution menace in the water bodies.
- d) It is an indigenous technology used in launching GSLV rockets.

Q.83) "I - Familia" was in the news recently. Which of the following statements describes it correctly ?

- a) The nomenclature procedure followed by WHO in naming variants of Covid-19 virus.
- b) An app developed by C-DAC to the movements of elderly living alone.
- c) A global database to identify missing persons through family DNA developed by Interpol.
- d) A software developed by the Food and Agriculture Organization to identify the evolved traits

between wild and cultivated variety of food crops.

Q.84) Burkina Faso is a landlocked country in West Africa, recently in the news, is surrounded by which of the following countries?

- 1. Nigeria
- 2. Niger
- 3. Mauritania
- 4. Ghana
- 5. Senegal
- 6. Mali

Select the correct answer from the codes given below:

- a) 1, 2, 3 and 5 only
- b) 2, 4 and 6 only
- c) 2, 3, 5 and 6 only
- d) 1, 2, 3, 4, 5 and 6

Q.85) Consider the following pairs with reference to species and their protection status:

Species	Protection Status
1. Saltwater crocodile	— Critically endangered
2. Olive Ridley turtle	— Vulnerable
3. Pygmy Hog	— Endangered

Which of the above pairs is/are correctly matched?

- a) 1 only
- b) 1 and 2 only
- c) 2 and 3 only
- d) 3 only

Q.86) Which of the following statements with reference to Shanghai Cooperation Organisation is correct?

- a) It was established immediately after the end of the Cold war to maintain peace in the region.
- b) Out of the 8 member countries, 5 are central Asian countries.
- c) Both India and Pakistan became members of the SCO in the same year.
- d) None of the above

Q.87) Which of the following organizations/institutions has recently released the Global Peace Index, 2021?

- a) Reporters without borders
- b) UNICEF
- c) World Economic Forum
- d) None of the above



Q.88) The term 'Bharitalasuchus tapani', recently seen in news, is related to:

- a) An early human species
- b) A geological period in the history of Indian subcontinent
- c) A carnivorous reptile species
- d) Pleistocene-era rock paintings in Indonesia

Q.89) Consider the following statements regarding the glacial lakes of Ganga basin:

- 1. Uttarakhand accounts for around 93% of the glacial lakes.
- 2. Yamuna sub-basin contains the highest count of the glacial lakes.
- 3. Lakes with more than 5 hectares of the area account for around 75% of the total number of lakes.

Which of the statements given above is/are incorrect?

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 2 and 3 only
- c) 1 and 3 only
- d) 1, 2, and 3

Q.90) Consider the following pairs:

- | | | |
|---------------------------------|---|----------------|
| 1. Raimona National Park | : | Assam |
| 2. Vishdhari Wildlife Sanctuary | : | Gujarat |
| 3. Netravali Wildlife Sanctuary | : | Goa |
| 4. Papikonda National Park | : | Andhra Pradesh |

Which of the pairs given above is/are correctly matched?

- a) 1 and 3 only
- b) 2 and 3 only
- c) 2 and 4 only
- d) 1 and 4 only

Q.91) Consider the following statements:

- 1. SAGE portal is aligned with the objectives mentioned under Article 41 of the Constitution.
- 2. Surakshit Hum Surakshit Tum Abhiyan was launched for the aspirational districts only.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 only
- c) Both 1 and 2
- d) Neither 1 nor 2

Q.92) In the context of GST, which of the statements given below is/are incorrect?

- 1. The GST on gold and unworked semi-precious stones is subject to the slab of 5%.

2. Value Added Tax in the liquor levied by the States have been subsumed under the GST.

Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 only
- c) Both 1 and 2
- d) Neither 1 nor 2

Q.93) Consider the following statements regarding the Non-Banking Financial Companies- Micro-finance Institutions in India:

- 1. The current definition of Microfinance borrowers classifies them into rural, urban, and semi-urban categories.
- 2. Presently, the RBI regulates all the entities registered under the microfinance sector under a single set of norms.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 only
- c) Both 1 and 2
- d) Neither 1 nor 2

Q.94) Which one of the statements given below is most appropriate regarding the LEAF Coalition?

- a) It is an initiative of the Least Developed and Island Countries that aims to arrest the global warming induced sea level rise.
- b) It is a public-private partnership that aims to mobilize finance for the protection of tropical forests.
- c) It is a United Nations led initiative that encourages afforestation in the Least Developed Countries.
- d) It is an initiative of Libya, Egypt, Algeria, and France to prevent the pollution in the Mediterranean Sea.

Q.95) Which of the following statements is/are correct about the Pradhan Mantri Awas Yojana (URBAN) ?

- 1) Economically weaker sections and low-income groups are the only beneficiaries under the Pradhan Mantri Awas Yojana (URBAN).
- 2) It is being implemented as a Centrally Sponsored Scheme except for the component of credit linked subsidy which is implemented as a Central Sector Scheme.

Select the correct answer using the codes given below.

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 only
- c) Both 1 and 2
- d) Neither 1 nor 2



Q.96) Lakshadweep comes under which of the following jurisdiction of the High Court ?

- a) Bombay High Court
- b) Kerala High Court
- c) Karnataka High Court
- d) None of the Above

Q.97) Which of the following provisions are provided under the article 324 of the constitution of India regarding the composition of the election commission?

- 1) The Election Commission shall be a three member body, consisting of the chief election commissioner and two election commissioners.
- 2) The president may appoint regional commissioners after consultation with the chief election commissioner of India.
- 3) The conditions of service and tenure of office of the election commissioners and the regional commissioners shall be determined by the Parliament.

Select the correct answer using the codes given below.

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 2 and 3 only
- c) 1 and 3 only
- d) None of the Above

Q.98) Recently, a negative imports list policy was in the news. Which of the following statements is correct about it?

- a) It contains a list of items that have been banned to import from China.
- b) The list comprises environmentally harmful items that could have a negative impact on India's INDC.
- c) It is the list of items that the Armed Forces will only procure from domestic manufacturers.
- d) None of the Above

Q.99) With reference to the Maintenance and Welfare of Parents and Senior Citizens Act, 2007, Consider the following statements:

- 1) It puts legal obligations on children to maintain their parents/grandparents and also the relatives of the senior citizens to maintain such senior citizens.
- 2) Under the act children include son, daughter, grandson, grand daughter, son-in-law and daughter-in-law.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct ?

- a) 1 only

- b) 2 only
- c) Both 1 and 2
- d) Neither 1 nor 2

Q.100) Consider the following statements:

- 1) H5N1 is the most common virus causing bird flu, or avian influenza and it is restricted to birds only.
- 2) All known subtypes of influenza A viruses can infect birds

Which of the statements given above is/are correct ?

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 only
- c) Both 1 and 2
- d) Neither 1 nor 2



Q.1) Ans: A

Exp:

- **Pair 1 is correct:** Charaka was the **court physician of Kushan king Kanishka**. He authored **Charak Samhita** and is one of the principal contributors to Ayurveda. Charaka Samhita deals with the **use of plants and herbs for medicinal purposes**. In Charak Samhita, an extensive note on **digestion, metabolism** and the **immune system** is written. Charak emphasises that the functioning of a human body depends on **three Doshas**: 1. **Bile**, 2. **Phlegm** and 3. **Wind**. These doshas are produced with the help of **blood, flesh and marrow** and an imbalance between these three doshas make the body sick.
- **Pair 2 is correct:** Kalidasa was one of the **nine jewels or navaratnas** of the court of **Chandragupta-II**. He had written three plays i.e. **Malavikagnimitra, Abhijnanashakuntalam** and **Vikramorvasiyam**. He has also written some epic poems i.e. **Raghuvamsa and Kumarasambhava**. Some of the other poems of Kalidasa are **Ritusamhara and Meghaduta**.
- **Pair 3 is incorrect:** **Brahmagupta** lived in the **7th century** and wrote **Brahma Sphuta Siddhantika** through which the Arabs came to know our mathematical system. In this book he mentioned **zero as a number**. He also introduced **negative numbers** and described them as debts and **positive numbers** as fortunes. It also contains the first description of the **Quadratic formula**. **Skandagupta** ruled in the **5th century from 455AD to 467AD**.

Reference:

Nitin Singhania (Chapter 18)

Q.2) Ans: C

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** In the Mauryan administration the king was the **fountainhead** of all authority and the administration was **centralized**. He was assisted by a **council of ministers** but the king himself took **all final decisions** regarding revenue, law and order, war or any other matter related to administration. However, the Gupta administration was **decentralized in nature**. **Feudatories**, i.e. Local kings and smaller chiefs ruled a large part of their empire, who were **subjugated by Samudragupta**.

- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** The Gupta bureaucracy was **not as elaborate and as organised** as its **Mauryan counterpart**. The widely prevalent cadre which supplied superior officers was that of the **kumaramatya**, corresponding to the **mahamatya of Asokan** and **amatya of Satavahana inscriptions**. Most high officers were **directly appointed by the king** in the home provinces and possibly, paid in **cash**.
- **Statement 3 is correct:** The Mauryan bureaucracy was **based on the merit**. For example, those who had come out successfully in **religious tests** were employed in **administrative justice**. But several offices of the Gupta administration came to be combined in the **hands of the same person** and posts became **hereditary**. For instance, **Harisena**, the composer of the **Allahabad pillar inscription of Samudragupta**, was a **mahadandanayaka** (chief judicial officer) as well as a **mahasandhivigrahika** (minister for war and peace), and also the **son of mahadandanayaka Dhruvabhuti**.

Reference:

RS Sharma (page no. 187), NIOS (page no. 76), Poonam Dalal Dahiya (Page no. 347)

Q.3) Ans: B

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is incorrect:** When James Prinsep succeeded in reading **Ashoka's Brahmi edicts**, it was not immediately clear to him just which king they referred to. This is because most of them refer to Ashoka by variants of two titles—**Devanampiya** (beloved of the gods) and **Piyadasi** (he who looks on auspiciousness). In later decades, versions of **Minor Rock Edict I** containing the personal name of the king—**Ashoka**—were found, first at **Maski**, and later at **Udegolam, Nittur, and Gujjara**.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** The **Rummindei inscription** informs about the visit of Ashoka to Lumbini where he made a stone bearing wall and caused a stone pillar to be set up in order to show that the **Blessed One (Buddha) was born here**. The **village of Lumbini** was **exempted from bali** and the **bhaga** (the royal share of the produce) was reduced to **one-eighth**.



- **Statement 3 is correct:** Total 182 inscriptions have been found from 47 places, which were composed in **Prakrit** and **written in Brahmi script** in the greater part of the subcontinent. But in **north-Western part** they appeared in **Aramaic language and Kharoshti script** and in Afghanistan both **Aramaic and Greek script and Language**.

Reference:

RS Sharma (page no. 127)

Krishna Reddy

Q.4) Ans: B

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is incorrect and Statement 2 is correct:** By the first century CE, there is evidence of **changes in Buddhist ideas and practices**. Early Buddhist teachings had given great importance to self-effort in achieving nibbana. Besides, the **Buddha** was regarded as a **human** being who attained **enlightenment and nibbana** through his own efforts. However, gradually the **idea of a saviour** emerged. Finally, Buddhism was divided into Hinayana and Mahayana in the **fourth Buddhist Council** held in Kundalvan in Kashmir under the royal patronage of Kanishka.
- **Mahayana** adopted **Sanskrit** as its language and started worshipping Buddha in the form of an idol, while Hinayana continued to follow **Pali** and treated Buddha as a guide.
- **Statement 3 is correct:** The most important work of the **Hinayana school is the Mahavastu** which is a storehouse of stories. While the **Lalitavistara** is the most sacred **Mahayana text** which supplied literary material for the **Buddhacharita** of **Asvaghosa**.

Reference:

NIOS (p. no. 66)

NCERT Class 12

Q.5) Ans: C

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** Early Kushan kings issued numerous gold coins with a **higher degree of metallic purity** than is found in the **Gupta gold coins**. Although the gold coins of the Kushans are found mainly **west of the Indus**, their inscriptions are distributed not only in north-western India

and Sindh but also in Mathura, Shravasti, Kaushambi, and Varanasi.

- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** Indo-Greek rule is important in the history of India because of the **large number of coins** that the Greeks issued. The Indo-Greeks were the first rulers in India to issue coins that can be **definitively attributed to particular kings**. This is **not possible** in the case of the early **punch-marked coins**, which cannot be assigned with certainty to any particular dynasty. The Indo-Greeks were also the **first to issue gold coins in India**, and these increased in number under the Kushans.
- **Statement 3 is correct:** Kushanas coined the precious metals of gold and copper into circular shapes and design, by **die-strike technique**, but in their own names, effigy and style. Nevertheless, like the Indo-Greeks coins, their original coins too had the **king figuring on the obverse** and some deity, preferably **Greek God, on the reverse**.

Reference

RS Sharma (page no. 142, 144)

<http://www.igntu.ac.in/eContent/MA-AIHC-04Sem-DrJitendraJain-%20Ancient%20Indian%20Coinage-Unit1-4.pdf>

Q.6) Ans: D

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** The Satavahanas retained some administrative structures of **Ashokan times**. Their district was called **ahara**, as it was known in the time of Ashoka, and their officials were known as **amatyas** and **mahamatras**, as was the case in Maurya times. However, their **administrative divisions** were also called **rashtra**, and their high officials were styled **maharashtrikas**. The **lowest level of administration was a grama (village), which was under the charge of a gaulmika**.
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** Satavahanas were the first in the Indian territory to make **tax free land grants to Buddhist and Brahmins** to gain **religious merits**. This practice became more prominent in succeeding periods. The Satavahana kings claimed to be Brahmanas and considered it their primary duty to **uphold the varna system** i.e. the four fold division of social structure.
- **Statement 3 is correct:** There was remarkable progress in the fields of **trade and industry** during the Satavahana rule. Merchants organized **guilds**



to increase their activities. The Satavahana period also witnessed **overseas commercial activity**. **Ptolemy** mentions many ports in the Deccan. The greatest port of the Satavahanas was **Kalyani on the west Deccan**. **Gandakasela** and **Ganjam** on the east coast were the other important seaports.

Reference:

NIOS (page no. 87), RS Sharma (page no. 158)

Q.7) Ans: C

Exp:

- **Option A is correct:** The best account of **Indo-Roman trade** is given in the book called the **Periplus of the Erythrean Sea**. Major items of export to the Romans were the Indian products such as **spices** (included **yavanapriya** or **pepper**), **perfumes, jewels, ivory and fine textiles** (muslin especially), several precious and semi-precious stones like **diamond, carnelian, turquoise, agate, sapphire**, and so on, besides pearls, **indigo, sandalwood, iron and steel cutlery**. Against this import, Romans exported **gold and silver to India**.
- **Option B is correct:** Though the concept of varna was known, social classes in the Sangam period were **not** marked by **higher or lower rankings** as in north India. For example, Brahmins were present in the society and they performed Vedic ceremonies and sacrifices and also acted as advisers to the chief but **they enjoyed no special privileges**.
- **Option C is incorrect:** Women in the Sangam period were **educated** and engaged in various **economic activities** such as paddy plantation, cattle rearing, basket-making, spinning etc. **Child marriage was absent** but the cruel **practice of Sati** was also **prevalent** in Tamil society, and it was known as **tippayadal**. But it was not obligatory as there are references to **widows** present in society. However, their **position was miserable** as they were prohibited to decorate themselves or participate in any form of amusement.

Reference:

NIOS (page no. 95, 96)

Q.8) Ans: C

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** One aspect of the **fertility-related beliefs** of the Harappans was the worship of **male and female creative energy** in the form of **stone icons** of lingas and yonis, whereas the people of Vedic period were **nature worshippers**. They found it **difficult to explain natural phenomena** like **rain**, the appearance of the **sun** and the **moon**, and the **existence of the rivers, mountains**, and the like. Thus, they attributed these phenomena to nature and worshipped it.
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** The Harappan people were **aware of almost all the metals except iron**. Although iron is sometimes attributed to **Lothal** and to some sites in **Afghanistan** in **Harappan times**. They are really **copper objects containing iron ores**. These ores have not been separated from copper and given a distinct and separate identity as a pure iron metal.
Around 1000 BC iron was used in the **Gandhara area in Pakistan**. **Iron implements buried with dead bodies** have been discovered in substantial numbers. Vedic period roughly corresponds with the early iron age in India. Iron tools were adopted by Vedic society, which allowed them to cut forests and the adoption of a more settled, agricultural way of life.
- **Statement 3 is correct:** There are so **many references to the cow** and the bull in the **Rig Veda** that the Rig Vedic people can be called predominantly pastoral people. Most of their wars were fought over cows. The terms for war in the Rig Veda is **gavishti** or **search for cows**, and cow seems to have been the **most important form of wealth**. On the other hand, Indus Valley people did not show the same regard for cows.

Reference:

RS Sharma (page no. 72, 80)

Upendra Singh

Q.9) Ans: C

Exp:

- **Option A is correct:** The Harappan script was **pictographic** and **logosyllabic** (each symbol stood for a word/syllable). Harappan writing was **boustrophedon**, that is to say, **right to left and left to right in alternate lines**. The Harappan script has **not been deciphered so far**.



- **Option B is correct:** According to Buddhist texts, **Anguttara Nikaya** (the land between Himalayas and Narmada) was divided into 16 independent states (Mahajanapadas) – **Anga, Magadh, Kasi, Vatsa, Kosala, Saurasena, Panchala, Kuru, Matsya, Chedi, Avanti, Gandhar, Kamboj, Asmaka, Vajji and Malla.**
- **Option C is incorrect:** **Visakhadatta's Devichandraguptam** tells us about **Ramagupta's defeat** by a Saka ruler (Basana), murder of the Saka ruler as well as Ramagupta by **Chandragupta II**, his accession to the throne and his **marriage to Dhruvadevi** (his brother's widow). **Visakhadatta's Mudrarakshasha** is a political drama that narrates the **ascent of king Chandragupta Maurya to power.**

Reference:

Poonam Dahiya Dalal (page no. 129)

Krishna Reddy (page no. 721)

Nitin Singhania

Q.10) Ans: D

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** The purpose of worship of Vedic period people was **materialistic and not spiritual**. They did not do so for their spiritual uplift or for **ending the miseries of existence**. They asked mainly for **praja** (children), **pashu** (cattle), **food, wealth, health** etc.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** The **asrama system** is found mentioned first in the **Aitareya Brahmana**. A much clearer reference to the three asramas occurs in the **Chandogya Upanishad**. In the **Jabala Upanishad**, Yajnavalkya expounds the **four asramas**. They meant mainly for regulating the life of the male members of the higher castes, they consisted of four stages: (a) **brahmacharin** or student life, (b) **grihastha** or life of the householder, (c) **vanaprastha** or partial retirement and (d) **sannyasin** (yati) or complete retirement (ascetic life).
- **Statement 3 is incorrect:** In the Rig Vedic period, there was **no official** connection with the collection of taxes and hence **no regular taxation was possible**. Only voluntary offerings, viz. **Bali**, from the people and also **spoils of war** formed the occasional income of the chief.

Reference:

RS Sharma (page no. 77)

Krishna Reddy (page no. 44, 48)

Q.11) Ans: B

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is incorrect:** **Visuddhimagga** or **The path of Purification** was written by **Buddhaghosha** in approximately the **5th century** under Theravada school of Buddhism. It discusses various stages to attain salvation. It discusses seven stages in the attainment of salvation to be followed by Theravada Buddhism.
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** **Buddhacharita** (a mahakavya) was written by **Ashvagosh** in Sanskrit about the life of Gautam Buddha. **Ashvagosh** (80 A.D. -150 A.D) was regarded as the first scholar to have used Sanskrit language for non religious purposes. He was a devout follower of the Mahayana Buddhist doctrine and a great poet prior to Kalidasa. He also authored **Sariputraprakarana** and **Saundarananda** (dealing with the conversion of Nanda to Buddhism to attain salvation).
- **Statement 3 is correct:** **Rajatarangini** was written by **Kalhan** in Sanskrit and gives an account of the rulers of Kashmir. Kalhan was a great historian of the Sanskrit language who wrote about the history of Kashmir in the **12th century**.

Source: statement 1: nitin singhania: pg: 14.9;
Statement 2&3:nitin singhania page: 15.12

Q.12) Ans: C

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** The **Kalsi** inscription depicts the humane approach in the Ashokan administration post his conversion to Buddhism. The inscription is located near Dehradun and is written in **Prakrit** with **Brahmi** script.
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** The name Ashoka has been mentioned in the **Maski inscription**, which also motivates people to follow Dhamma whereas **Kanaganahalli** (Karnataka) inscription refers to Ashoka as **Ranyo Ashoka** in **Brahmi script**. It belongs to the **Satavahana period**.
- **Statement 3 is correct:** Gautam Buddha gave his first sermon to five disciples in the Deer park in Sarnath, Varanasi. This event was called as turning the wheel of law or **Dharmachakrapravartana**.



The **Dhamek stupa** is also situated in Sarnath, Varanasi.

Source: nitin singhania: pg 1.16 and 1.17

Source: nitin singhania page 1.25 and 1.26

Q.13) Ans: B

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is incorrect:** The **Pala** rulers who ruled over the Bengal region in the 8th to 12th Century AD were mainly Buddhists and followed **Mahayana Buddhism**.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** Famous universities like **Odantapuri** in Bihar were built by the Pala ruler **Gopala I. Vikramshila**, Bhagalpur, Bihar was built by the **King Dharampala** and was a centre of learning mainly for Vajrayana Buddhism.
- **Statement 3 is incorrect:** Although Pala rulers were mainly Buddhists, they constructed Hindu temples as well. Hence, their architecture had influence from both **Hinduism and Buddhism**.

Source: nitin singhania page 1.43, 1.44, 1.45

Q.14) Ans: C

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** The Mathura school of art was developed indigenously and was devoid of any external influence. It was built using **red sandstone** under the patronage of **Kushana rulers**. It was influenced by all three religions, **Buddhism, Jainism, and Hinduism**. It depicts the Buddha in a smiling state. It is found in the areas around Mathura, Kankalitila, Sonak.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** The **Indo-greek** or the **Gandhara school** of art had indo-greek influence and was not purely indigenous. It used **grey sandstone** and was also patronized by the **Kushana rulers**. It was mainly Buddhist and shows the **spiritual mood** of Buddha. It developed in the areas around present day Kandhar.
- **Statement 3 is incorrect:** The **Amaravati school** of art was indigenously developed and mainly focused on **Buddhism**. It used **white marbles** and was patronized by the **Satavahana rulers**. It was developed in the lower valleys of Krishna-Godavari around Amravati and Nagarjunakonda.

Q.15) Ans: B

Exp:

- Nalanda was the most renowned university of South Asia. It is not clear as to who established it; it was in existence during the Gupta period. It gained **prominence under Harshavardhana's reign and Pala kings**.
- **All three Buddhist doctrines** were taught here, however, it was a **major site for Mahayana Buddhist teachings**. Subjects like Vedas, fine arts, grammar, philosophy, logic, medicine, etc. were also taught here.
- It attracted scholars from Central Asia, South-East Asia and other parts of the world. The teachings in the university **deeply influenced Tibetan Buddhism**.
- **Famous scholars of Nalanda** are **Nagarjuna (Madhyamika Shunyavad)** and **Aryabhatta the astronomer**.
- **Huen Tsang** spent two years at the university. Another Chinese scholar, **I-Tsing**, spent 10 years at Nalanda in the late 7th century. **Hence, only 2 and 4 are correct.**

Reference: Art and culture by Nitin Singhania, Chapter 1

Q.16) Ans: D

Exp:

- **Vikramshila:** It is located in present-day **Bhagalpur district of Bihar**. It was established by **King Dharampala of Pala Dynasty**, primarily as a **Buddhist learning centre**. The scholars were invited by kings outside India to spread Buddhist teachings. The **Vajrayana sect of Buddhism** flourished here and Tantric teachings were taught. Other subjects like logic, Vedas, astronomy, urban development, law, grammar, philosophy, etc. were also taught. **Hence, pair 1 is not correctly matched.**
- **Manyakheta:** now called **Malkhed (Karnataka)**, it rose to prominence under the **Rashtrakuta rule**. Scholars of **Jainism, Buddhism and Hinduism**



studied here. It has a 'matha' of Dvaita school of thought. **Hence, pair 2 is not correctly matched.**

- **Nalanda**: It was the most renowned university of South Asia. **It is not clear as to who established it; it was in existence during the Gupta period.** It gained prominence under Harshavardhana's reign and Pala kings. All three Buddhist doctrines were taught here, however, it was a major site for Mahayana Buddhist teachings. Subjects like Vedas, fine arts, grammar, philosophy, logic, medicine, etc. were also taught here. It attracted scholars from Central Asia, South-East Asia and other parts of the world. The teachings in the university deeply influenced Tibetan Buddhism. Famous scholars of Nalanda are Nagarjuna (Madhyamika Shunyavad) and Aryabhatta the astronomer. Huen Tsang spent two years at the university. Another Chinese scholar, I-Tsing, spent 10 years at Nalanda in the late 7th century. **Hence, pair 3 as well is not correctly matched.**

Reference: Art and culture by Nitin Singhania,
Chapter 1

Q.17) Ans: C

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct.** Every guild was registered with the central authority of the State and the king was the chief administrative authority on them.
- **Statement 2 is Incorrect.** : Shrenis also served as banks, rich men as well as women deposited money. This was invested, and part of the interest was returned or used to support religious institutions such as monasteries.
- **Statement 3 is correct.** The Shrenis had Executive, Regulatory and judicial power over its own members. The wages, rules of work, standards and prices were fixed by the registered guilds. Shrenis even punished one who broke the rule framed by guilds.

Source of reference : Ancient Indian History OLD NCERT

UPSC question referred for this: 2019 UPSC Similar question on Iqta system , Vishti forced labour system asked.

Q.18) Ans: B

Exp

- **Pair 1 is incorrect:** Chirand is an archaeological site in Bihar. It is situated on the northern bank of the river Ganga. It is the first known site of the Neolithic age. It has a large prehistoric mound containing various artifacts. The mound is known for its continuous archaeological record from the Neolithic age (about 2500–1345 BC) to the reign of the Pal Dynasty, which ruled this place during the pre-medieval period.
- **Pair 2 is incorrect:** Koldihwa is an archeological site located in Allahabad on the left bank of the Belan River. The site contains excavations of Neolithic, Chalcolithic and Iron age phases.
- **Pair 3 is incorrect:** The Burzahom archaeological site is located in the Kashmir Valley of the Indian state of Jammu and Kashmir. Archaeological excavations have revealed four phases of cultural significance between 3000 BC and 1000 BC. Periods I and II represent the Neolithic era, Period III the Megalithic era, and Period IV relates to the early Historical Period. It is situated on a high terrace, which is part of the flow of the river Jhelum.
- **Pair 4 is correct:** Gufkral (literally Gulf – cave Kral – potter) is located in the south Kashmir district, considered as one of the sites in the valley which has been dated by archaeologists to the Neolithic period. It is part of river Jhelum and falls between two nallahs (streams) on an extensive deposit of Karewa (elevated table-land) where people used to live in ancient times.

Q.19) Ans: D

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is incorrect** - The Pandya rulers created a number of irrigation sources and as a result agriculture flourished during the Pandyan times. The trade activities also flourished immensely. They exempted traders from various kinds of port dues and tolls. Kayal was their great port. Marco Polo, the famous traveller from Venice, visited Kayal twice, in 1288 and in 1293. He tells us that this port town was full of ships from



Arabia and China and bustling with business activities.

- **Statement 2 is incorrect** - The Delhi Sultanate ruler Allaudin Khilji, sent his general Malik Kafur to the Southernmost Kingdoms. He invaded the Pandyan Kingdom. He plundered the city of Madurai. The Madurai temple was desecrated and an enormous amount of wealth was looted. After Malik Kafur's invasion, the Pandyan kingdom came to be divided among a number of the main rulers in the Pandya's family.
- **Statement 3 is incorrect** - Cholas undertook measures to improve the irrigation system. For the periodical or seasonal maintenance and repair of irrigation works, conscripted labour was used. Village assemblies under the Cholas collected a tax called eriyam, which was utilised for repairing irrigation tanks.

Q.20) Ans: D

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is incorrect** - The Dravidian style of art and architecture reached its perfection under the Cholas. The Brihadisvara Temple (Gangaikondacholapuram, Tamil Nadu) built by Rajendra I and the Airavatesvara Temple (Darasuram) built by Rajaraja II are remarkable examples of the Dravidian style of architecture.
- **Statement 2 is incorrect** - The monolithic rathas and the Mandapas found at Mamallapuram are notable architecture of the pallavas.
- Some facts about Mamallapuram are as follows- Mamallapuram / Mahabalipuram/ Seven Pagodas, was founded by a 7th-century Hindu Pallava King—Narasimhavarman, also known as Mamalla. It's main attractions are- The sculptured rock relief popularly known as "Arjuna's Penance," or "Descent of the Ganges," and The Five Rathas, or monolithic temples. It is also one of the UNESCO World Heritage Sites of India.
- **Statement 3 is incorrect** - Rock cut architecture is one of the significant part of the Pandyan architecture. The prominent rock-cut cave temples created by the early Pandyas are found in Pillayarpatti, Tirumeyyam, Kuntrakkudi, Tiruchendur, Kalugumalai, Kanyakumari and Sittannavasal.

Q.21) Ans: B

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is Incorrect-** Simhavishnu defeated the Kalabhras and laid the foundation of the Pallava rule in Tondaimandalam. He also defeated the Cholas and extended the Pallava territory up to the river Kaveri.
- **Statement 2 is Correct-** Simhavishnu was patron of Bharavi. Bharavi was a great Sanskrit poet who wrote one of the greatest classical Sanskrit epics that was hailed as Mahakavya or great poetry i.e Kiratrjuniya- it is the dialogue between Arjuna and Shiva and in which Shiva blessed Arjuna with the Pasupata Shastra. Bharavi was a great Sanskrit poet who wrote one of the greatest classical Sanskrit epics that was hailed as Mahakavya or great poetry.

Q.22) Ans: D

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** The Dravida or south Indian style of architecture reached its climax during the Chola rule. The chief feature of a Chola temple is the vimana or the storey, which was later transformed by the richly ornamented gopuram or gateway. Under the Cholas, temples became the centre of life, particularly in the rural areas. The village assembly held its meetings in the temple mandapa, which later became an additional feature of the Chola temple architecture.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** The Chola period also saw a great development in the field of sculpture making. Portraits, icons and decorative sculpture were the three main types of Chola sculpture. The Chola sculptors started bronze-casting sometime around the middle of the 9th century. The Cholas are particularly known for their Nataraja bronzes (bronze statues of Nataraja or the dancing Shiva) which are masterpieces of this kind of art. Nataraja image in the Nageshwara temple of Kumhakonam is the best example.
- **Statement 3 is correct:** The Rajarajeshvara temple scenes representing Shiva in his abode of Kailasa as Nataraja and Tripuranataka are painted on the walls in large and forceful compositions. Chola wall paintings are found on the walls of the



Vijayalaya Cholesvara temples where painted figures of Mahakal, Devi and Siva are still visible.

Source: B-61 Indian History by Krishna Reddy.

Q.23) Ans: D

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** There was a regular land revenue department (**Puravu Vari tinaikkalam**) during the Chola period and a well maintained record of land rights, surveys and keeping of fresh entries (Varippottagam) highlighting a well organized tax assessment and tax collection mechanism.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** There was differentiation in the central taxes and the local cesses, the latter was collected by the local authorities with the central authorities providing them full assistance in enforcing their demands.
- **Statement 3 is correct:** Analysis through statistics and the chronology and spatial distribution of tax terminology and the context of their occurrence have revealed that the major land tax (kadamai) was standardized, along with a number of small ones related to land.
- **Statement 4 is correct:** To avoid central collection of taxes and redistribution of the same, there was provision of local form of collection and a reinvestment of such revenues in the regional economy.

Source: NCERT and B-59 Indian History by Krishna Reddy.

Q.24) Ans: A

Exp:

- **Simhavishnu** is considered as the first important pallava ruler and was a follower of Vaishnavism which is evident from the archaeological evidence from that period.
- **Mahendravarman I** (590- 630) reign marked a constant feud between the Chalukyas and Pallavas. Pulakesin II is considered the greatest of the Chalukya rulers of Badami. His first expedition against the Pallava kingdom, which was then ruled by Mahendravarman I, was a complete

success, and he annexed the northern part of the Pallava kingdom.

- **Narasimhavarman I** was the greatest of Pallava rulers. He is credited with repelling the second invasion of Pulakesin II, killing him and capturing the Chalukyan capital Vatapi and thereby assuming the title of 'Vatapikonda' (conqueror of Vatapi). He also defeated the Cholas, Cheras and the Pandyas. He also helped his ally, a Ceylonese prince to capture the throne of Ceylon by sending naval expeditions to Ceylon. Hiuen Tsang visited Kanchipuram during his reign. Narasimhavarman I founded the city of Mamallapuram (Mahabalipuram) which is famous for its rock-cut temples.
- **Narasimhavarman II** is also known as Rajasimha, his rule is marked by peace and prosperity, literary activities and construction of large and beautiful temples out of which the Shore temple of Mahabalipuram is famous. He is also said to have sent embassies to China, and maritime trade flourished during his reign.
- **Nandivarman II** gave a huge ransom and his daughter in marriage to Vikramaditya II when he invaded and captured the Pallava capital. During his reign, several old temples were renovated and new ones like Vaikuntaperumal temples at Kanchi were constructed.

Source: NCERT (Ancient India, XI): Page 214

Q.25) Ans: A

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** Both Bharavi and Dandin, the authors of Kirtarjuniya and Dasakumaracharita respectively, lived in the Pallava court. The other literary works that were well known during the Pallava period were that of the scientific works of Varahamihira and the poetry of Kalidasa.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** Mahendravarman I was famous for his satirical works and wrote the famous burlesque, **Mattavilasa Prahasana** written in Sanskrit in the beginning of 7th century. The work pokes fun at the peculiar aspects of the heretic Kapalika and Pasupata Saivite sects, Buddhism and Jainism. The other important work of Mahendravarman is **Bhagavadajjuka**.
- **Statement 3 is incorrect:** The capital city of the Pallava kingdom, Kanchi was the great centre of



Sanskrit learning, whereas the city of Pattadakal was famous for its temples and architecture during the reign of Chalukyas. Pattadakal is represented as the second state of temple building under the Chalukyas and consists of about 10 temples (four in Northern Style and Six in the Southern style).

Source: A 406 Indian History by Krishna Reddy. NCERT.

Q.26) Ans: C

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** The central government under the Chalukyas of Badami exercised a paternalistic control over the village administration, which was unlike the administrative practice of south India at that time. Unlike the Pallavs and the Cholas, the Chalukyan rulers did not give a great amount of autonomy to the village administration.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** The Chalukyas of Badami consisted of a small standing army, but mainly of feudal levies. Army officers seem to have been used in civil administration whenever an emergency arose. They also boasted a great maritime power. Pulakesin II, with 100 ships attacked and captured neighbouring hostile kingdoms.

Source: A 404 Indian History by Krishna Reddy

Q.27) Ans: A

Exp:

- **Pulakesin I** (543-566 AD) was the founder of the Chalukya dynasty. He established a small kingdom Badami (Vatapi) as its capital.
- **Kirtivarman I** (566-597 AD) was the son of Pulakesin I, and expanded the kingdom by wars against the Kadambas of Banavasi and the Nalas of Bastar.
- **Vikramaditya I** (644-681 AD) drove out the Pallava forces, and consolidated the kingdom. Later he plundered Kanchi, the capital of the Pallavas, thus avenging his father's (Pulakesin II) defeat in the hands of Pallava ruler Narasimhavarman I.
- **Vikramaditya II** (733-744 AD) invaded Pallava kingdom three times, and repelled the Arab invasion of South Gujarat.

- **Kirtivarman II** (744-755 AD) was the last Chalukyan ruler of Badami and was defeated by Dantidurga, the founder of the Rashtrakuta dynasty, marking the end of the Chalukyan dynasty.

Source: Page A 403 Indian History by Krishna Reddy.

Q.28) Ans: A

Exp:

- **Melagitti Sivalaya temple** is a small but finely proportioned and magnificently crafted temple located at Badami and is considered as one of the temples from the first stage of temple building activity of the Chalukyas.
- **Hucimaligudi temple** is one of the temples from the temple town of Aihole and was constructed during the Chalukyas. It is similar to Durga temple in terms of experimentation of adopting Buddhist chaityas to a Brahmanical temple but is smaller in size than the Durga temple.
- **Meguti temple** is a Jain temple from the Chalukyan period located in the temple town of Aihole. It represents the starting phase of erection of structural temples.
- **Ladh Khan temple** is a flat roofed building located in the town of Aihole and is one of the most important temples of the Chalukyan period.
- **Papanatha temple** is located at Pattadakal and is one of the temples from the second stage of temple building during the reign of Chalukyas. It is the most notable among the temples of the northern style, and it also reveals attempts to combine Nagara style and Dravidian style in one structure.
- **Virupaksha temple** is located at Pattadakal and was built by one of the Queens of Vikramaditya II. It is a direct imitation of the Kailasanatha temple of Kanchi.
- **Anantesvara temple** is located at Untavalli (Guntur District) and represents the Mahendra group of temple architecture of the Pallavas. The influence of cave style of architecture is seen in this group of temples. Another example being the rock cut temples at Bhairavakonda (North Arcot District).

Source: A 403 Indian History Krishna Reddy, Ncert



Q.29) Ans: B

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is Incorrect** - The Chalukya administration was **highly centralized** unlike that of the Pallavas and the Cholas. **Village autonomy was absent** under the Chalukyas and a **feudatory system was adopted**. They also adopted a monarchical form of government.
- **Statement 2 is Correct** - The Chalukyas gave respect and importance to Vedic rites and rituals. **The founder of the dynasty Pulakesin I performed the asvamedha sacrifice.**
- **Statement 3 is Correct** - **The Aihole inscription written by Ravikirti, a poet and also the adviser to the king Pulakeshin II.** The inscription is found at Aihole in Karnataka state, India. The inscription mentions the Chalukya family and king Pulakeshin II royal patron's support in the construction of the Meguti Jain temple. **This inscription also mentions Pulakeshin II victory over the Southern Kingdom of the Pallavas.** The inscription is in Sanskrit, and uses the Kannada script.

Q.30) Ans: B

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is not correct** - Vellanvagai refers to Land of non-Brahmanical peasants and the land given to Brahmanas were called Brahmadeya. Brahmadeya helped to bring new land under cultivation
- **Statement 2 is not correct** - Tirunamattukkani also called Devadana were the land gifted to temples.
- **Statement 3 is correct** - Pallichchandam were the land donated to Jaina institutions and Shalabhoga were the land for the maintenance of school.

Q.31) Ans: A

Exp:

- The Chahamanas of **Shakambhari**, also known as the Chauhanas of **Sambhar**, were a dynasty that ruled

the present day parts of Rajasthan during the 6th to 12th century time period.

- **Ajayameru** was established by a Chahamanas ruler Ajayaraja I and served as capital until the 12th century. Ajayameru is translated as invincible hills. It is the modern day **Ajmer** and surrounded by Aravalli hills.
- **Mankhet**, modern day **Malkhed** is in Karnataka, situated on the southwest part of Hyderabad. The city was founded in the 9th century by the Rashtrakuta ruler Amoghavarsha I and became the capital of the dynasty.
- **Kanyakubja** is the classical name of the modern day **Kannauj** city in Uttar Pradesh. It was also known as Mahodaya during the time of Gujarat samrat Mihir Bhoja (9th Century AD). The kanyakubja brahmins who included Shandilya were held as the three prominent families originally from Kannauj. Kanyakubja was the centre of the tripartite struggle between the Pala, Rashtrakuta and Pratihara.
- The Kannadiga dynasty is known as the **Kalyani** Chalukya after the name of its capital at **Kalyani**, it is today's **Basavakalyan** in the modern **Bidar** district of the Karnataka state.

Source: Medieval India History, NCERT: Page 65

Q.32) Ans: A

Exp:

- **Option a is correct : Mahmud** (998-1030) was the son of Alaptgin and organised stout defence against the Central Asian Turkish tribal invaders. His raids to India aimed at plundering the rich temples and cities to finance his Central Asia campaigns. Mahmud posed as a great but **'shikan'** or destroyer of images for the protection of Islam. From Punjab Mahmud raided Thanesar, the old capital of Harsha. His most daring raids however, were against Kannauj in 1018 and against Somnath in Gujarat in 1025. Mahmud broke the Sivalingam, and ordered parts of it brought back with him to Ghazni.
- **Option b is incorrect** : The empire that included Syria, Iran and Trans-Oxiana and contended with the Ghaznavids for the control of Khurasan were the Seljuk empire.
- **Option c is incorrect** : Arab and Turkish invaders were not known by any such names. The Arab



invasion started Mohammed - bin -Qasim who conquered Sindh with the permission of the Caliph Walid. Turks dominated the Caliphs of Baghdad(during the 8th and 9th century) and they extended their dominion beyond Sindh and Multan into India.

- **Option d is incorrect** : Rules and regulations framed by the Sultan for a smooth and efficient running of the administration was known as **zawabit**.

Source:Medieval Indian History NCERT:Page 61.

Q.33) Ans: A

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct** : Mahmud's invasion of India commenced in 1000 AD, when he captured some forts near Laghman (modern day Jalalabad, a city in Afghanistan). Apart from this, Lamghan is also famous Aramaic Inscriptions; it is an inscription on a slab of natural rock written in Aramaic by the Indian emperor Ahsoka around 260 BCE, and often categorized as one of the minor rock edicts of Ashoka.
- **Statement 2 is correct** : The invasions of Mahmud was invariably during the dry part of the year because the onset of monsoon will lead to the filling of the rivers of Punjab, thus creating hindrance for his troops and cargo which was loaded with the plunderings made in India.
- **Statement 3 is correct** : The Hindushahi dynasty ruling the territory around the Hindukush mountains was the first to come in conflict with the Ghaznavids. They were also known as Kabul Shahis and ruled the kabul valley, Gandhara (Pakistan) and North West India during 850-1026 AD. The rulers of the dynasty like Lalliya(Founder of the Hindushahi dynasty), Kamala toramana, Bhimadeva, Jaipala, Anadapala offered resistance to the Ghaznavids initially but later succumbed to them after repeated attacks. From 1000 AD until 1025 AD Mahmud launched a total of 17 campaigns and captured places as far distant as Kannauj and Saurashtra and returned back each time with greater volume of plundered booty.
- **Statement 4 is incorrect** : Mahmud defeated most of the Indian kingdoms that came along his path of plundering India, he did not hesitate to mete out the same treatment to the Muslim ruler

of Multan, whose territory blocked the path of Mahmud.

Source: Page B 104-105 Indian History and News Paper Article.

Q.34) Ans: A

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct**: Mahmud's deeds became legendary. They were memorized and passed down through generations, he became admirers of many due to the reason for his pillage, plunder and murdering policy of heretics and infidels. In the 14th century, two Sunni authors, Barani and Isami-writing in Delhi and in the Deccan Bahmani Kingdom, respectively- praised Mahmud as an ideal Muslim ruler because he persecuted rival Muslims sects of Shias and Ismailis, as well as non-believers.
- **Statement 2 is correct**: He attacked the kingdom of Multan twice, it was ruled by a muslim ruler named Daud, who was an Ismaili(rival muslim sect). In this subsequent onslaught on Multan, he killed many local muslims because they had not kept their promise of returning to orthodox Islam.
- **Statement 3 is incorrect**: Mahmud was extremely generous to only those poets who composed glowing eulogies on him. He did not appreciate other learned men, for instance Firdausi was not adequately paid for his work (Shah Namah) and Al-Beruni was taken captive after the fall of Khwarazm Shah in 1017.

Source: Page B 104/105 Indian history by krishna Reddy and NCERT

Q.35) Ans: C

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct**: Mahmud's astounding military success was not entirely due to his skills, army or valour. The political situation was very ripe for an invader during the onset of the 11th century. The power struggle between the North, Central and Eastern rulers resulted in the weakening of all of them. It had sapped the vitality and strength of the Gurjara Pratiharas and no formidable power had arisen in the early 11th century in Northern India to take their place in defending the Northern plain from an invader.



- **Statement 2 is correct:** The greatest and the most powerful dynasty of India at that time was the Cholas, but they were so deep down the southern part of India that they hardly took a note of it and did not consider the incursions of Mahmud of Ghazni as a threat.

Source: Page B 105 Indian History and NCERT

Q.36) Ans: C

Exp:

- In 1205 AD, **Ghori while entering India came across stiff resistance from the Khokhar tribe** of Punjab region, but he defeated them. Khokhar tribes were warrior tribes, good at fighting and in 1206 when Ghori after his brief stay in India was returning to Ghazni was killed by the Khokhars in Dharmyak district near Jhelum river (Modern day Pakistan).

Source: NCERT

Q.37) Ans: D

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** The Delhi Sultanate had its origins in the victories of Muhammad Ghori, he defeated Prithviraj Chauhan in 1192 AD thus establishing a firm control over north India. When Muhammad Ghori died in 1206 AD, his trusted genera, Qutubuddin Aibak declared an independent dynasty in Delhi which was known as Mamluk dynasty and was the first in a series that became collectively known as Delhi Sultanate.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** The Delhi Sultanate consisted of five short lived dynasties of the Sultanate based in Delhi. The first three (Mameluk, Khalji and Tughlaq) of which were of Turkish origin, the fourth was the Sayyid dynasty (Multan), and the last was the Lodhi dynasty, which was of Afghan origin.

Q.38) Ans: A

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** He was not prepared to share power with anyone, not even his family members. He even poisoned his own cousin Sher Khan to achieve this objective. Balban was

determined to finally squash the power of the chahalgani (group of 40 Turkish nobles) and to exalt the power and prestige of the monarchy. He was respectful of the ulema but did not let them interfere in state affairs.

- **Statement 2 is correct:** In order to win the confidence of the public, he administered justice with extreme partiality. Not even the highest nobility in the land were spared if they transgressed his authority. Instances of awarding exemplary punishment to his nobles like, the father of the Governor of Awadh and Badaun for cruelty to their personal slaves are there. To keep himself well informed, he appointed spies in every department.
- **Statement 3 is incorrect:** Balban did not go for fresh conquests (except one in Bengal: Tughrill episode-Balban's slave and Governor of Bengal rebelled against him). He recognized the internal dangers from the rebellions of the nobles that he suppressed and the external dangers from the Mongols. He created a separate military department called diwan-i-arz and maintained a strong centralized army. When most of the Muslim states had disappeared in the face of Mongol onslaught, the Sultanate of Delhi stood out almost alone as the champions of Islam.

(Source: Page 80-82 NCERT: History of Medieval India by Satish Chandra.)

Q.39) Ans: D

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is incorrect:** Firoz Shah Tughlaq made the iqtadari system hereditary. He made a rule that whenever a noble died, his son should be allowed to succeed to his position, including this iqta, and if he had no son, his son in law and in his absence, his slave. He followed a lenient approach towards the nobles in case of revenue collection mismatch unlike his predecessors. These steps pleased the nobles and were a major factor for the absence of rebellions by the nobles during his time.
- **The Iqtadari system** was a unique type of land distribution and administrative system that evolved during the reign of Iltutmish. Empire was evenly distributed into large and small tracts of

land called iqta to various nobles and officers for better administration and revenue collection.

- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** It was established by **Muhammad Bin Tughlaq** to extend and improve the cultivation in the doab. Under this the area was divided into development blocks headed by an official whose job was to extend cultivation by giving loans to the cultivators and to induce them to cultivate superior crops –wheat in place of barley, grapes and dates in place of sugarcane etc. Policy of extending and improving cultivation was taken up by Firoz shah Tughlak and later on to a larger scale by Akbar
- **Statement 3 is correct:** During his reign Jizya became a separate tax, earlier it was part of the land revenue. He refused to exempt the Brahmins from the payment of jizya, since it was mentioned in the sharia law. Only women, children, disabled and the indigent who had no means of livelihood were exempt from it. He tried to ban practices which the orthodox theologians believed to be un-Islamic, he prohibited muslim women going out to worship at the graves of the saints.
- **Statement 4 is correct:** After his accession, Firoz Shah Tughlaq was faced with the problem of preventing the imminent break up of the Delhi Sultanate. He adopted a policy of trying to appease the nobles, the army and the theologians and asserted his authority only over such areas which could be easily administered from Delhi. He therefore made no attempt to reassert his authority over South India and Deccan. He led two campaigns into Bengal, but was unsuccessful in both and resulted in the loss of Bengal

(Source: Page 113-114 NCERT: History of Medieval India by Satish Chandra.)

Q.40) Ans: A

Exp:

- **Diwan-i-Arz: Balban** reorganised the military department and established diwan-i arz, to deal with the internal and external disturbances. It was managed by **Arz-i-mamalik.**
- **Diwan-i-Risalat:** it was the department of religious affairs which dealt with pious foundations and gave stipends to deserving scholars and men of piety. Grants were made by this department also for the construction and maintenance of mosques,

tombs, and madrasas. It was headed by chief Sadr who also functioned as Chief Qazi, as the head of the judicial department.

- **Diwan-i-bandagan:** Department of slaves created by **Firoz Shah Tughlaq.** To look after the slaves and take responsibility for it.
- **Diwan-i-wazarat:** Finance department headed by the **wazir** (Prime minister). To look after the financial organization of the state.
- **Diwan-i-kohi:** Department of agriculture created by **Muhammud -Bin-Tughlaq.** To increase agricultural production and set up a loan system for the benefit of the farmers.
- **Diwan-i-insha:** Department of correspondence and records of the royal court. It was headed by **amir-munshi.**

(Source: NCERT Medieval India. Chapter 6 and 7)

Q.41) Ans: A

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** Alauddin sought to fix the cost of all commodities from food grains, sugar and cooking oil to needle, and from costly imported cloth to horses, cattle and slave boys and girls. Regulation of prices, especially food grains, was a constant concern of medieval rulers, because without the supply of cheap food grains to the towns, they could not hope to enjoy the support of the citizens and the army stationed there for fear of any foreign invasion.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** Alauddin set up three markets at Delhi, one market for food grains, the second for costly cloth and the third for horses, cattle and slaves. Each market was under the control of a high officer called shahna who maintained a register of the merchants, and strictly controlled the shopkeepers and prices. Spies were employed who reported to the sultan on the state of affairs in the market. By these measures Alauddin was able to put an end to smuggling, hoarding, black marketing and speculation.
- **Statement 3 is incorrect:** The Mongol invasions of Delhi had pinpointed the need to raise a large army to check them, but such an army would exhaust the royal treasure unless the state could lower the prices of the daily commodities and hence lower their salaries. To realize this



objective, Alauddin declared that the land revenue in the doab region would be paid directly to the state, that is the villagers in the area would not be assigned in iqta to anyone and the land revenue was increased to half of the produce.

(Source: Statement 1, 2 and 3 from page 102. NCERT Medieval India.)

Q.42) Ans: B

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is incorrect:** The **Hindu Shahi** kingdom extended from Punjab to Kabul, and it faced the invasion of **Mahmud of Ghazni** in 1001 AD. Mahmud of Ghazni raided the Hindu Shahi Kingdom during the rule of **Jayapala** and defeated him. The successor of Jayapala, Anandapala fought against Ghazni in the **Battle of Waihind in 1008 AD**. Anandapala was defeated at this battle and Mahmud extended his rule to large parts of Punjab.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** It is believed that **Mahmud of Ghazni** carried out 17 raids in India and the raids were mainly aimed at looting India of its riches. It raided the Nagarkot region of Punjab Hills, Thaneshwar in Delhi, Mathura, Kannauj, Gujarat, and plundered the famous temple of Somnath after defeating the Solanki king.
- **Statement 3 is correct:** The **Hindu Shahi** kingdom suffered attacks of **Mahmud of Ghazni**. After the second **Battle of Waihind**, there was a total decline of the Hindu Shahi kingdom in 1008 AD. He defeated the rulers of Hindu Shahi, Jayapala and Anandapala who had put a strong resistance against the invasion of Mahmud.

Source: TN pg: 166, 167

Q.43) Ans: A

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** **Alauddin Khilji** extended the rule of Khilji Dynasty as far as Madurai. He conquered the Deccan and the far areas of the South. He fought against the four great dynasties: **Yadavs of Devagiri**, whose ruler Ramachandra Dev submitted to Alauddin. Malik Kafur was sent by Alauddin to **Warangal** and defeated its ruler Pratabarudra Deva. The **Hoysala ruler**, Vira Ballala

III was defeated by Malik Kafur. Lastly, **Malik Kafur looted the Pandya Kingdom** and its capital **Madurai**, when its ruler Vira Pandya fled Madurai.

- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** The **Vijayanagar Kingdom** was founded by Harihara and Bhukka in 1336 of Sangama Dynasty. **Kumarakampana** was a ruler of Sangam Dynasty who marched against the Sultans of Madurai and defeated them extending the rule of the Vijayanagar to as far as the Rameshwaram. The expedition of Kumarakampana to Madurai is described in *Madhuravijayam*, composed by his wife, Gangadevi.

Source: TN pg: 181, 210

Q.44) Ans: B

Exp:

- **Option 1 is correct:** **Nicolo Conti** Was from Italy who visited Vijayanagar Kingdom during the reign of Devraya I. Conti refers to the prevalence of slavery in society. He also inferred that dancing, music, wrestling, gambling and cock-fighting were some of the amusements of the society.
- **Option 2 is incorrect:** **Paes** was from Portugal. He visited the Vijayanagar Kingdom during the rule of Krishnadevaraya. Paes mentioned the beautiful houses of the rich and the large number of Their household servants. Paes also refers to the flourishing devadasi system in the kingdom.
- **Option 3 is incorrect:** **Fernao Nuniz** was also from Portugal. He also visited Vijayanagar Kingdom during the rule of Achyut Devraya. According to Nuniz, a large number of women were employed in royal palaces as dancers, domestic servants and palanquin bearers. Nuniz also provided a description of the Sati system in society. He also mentioned excavation of canals and irrigation facilities.
- **Option 4 is incorrect:** **Abdur Razzaq** was from Persia. He visited Vijayanagar Kingdom during the reign of Devraya II. He had elaborated about the magnificence of cities. He also mentioned that the country was fairly cultivated and very fertile. He also mentioned that there were a heavy number of soldiers in the empire.

Source: NCERT and TN History



Ref: Which one of the following foreign travellers elaborately discussed about diamonds and diamond mines of India?

Q.45) Ans: B

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** Mandapa in temple architecture is space outside Garbhagriha to perform Public rituals. More than one mandapas were a feature of vijayanagara architecture. The central mandap came to be known as kalyana mantapa. The Kalyana Mandap was dedicated to divine marriage. Shrines in the shape of intricately shaped designs were a feature of Hoysala art. In hoysala art multiple shrines were built around the central pillared hall. This was called the stellate plan.
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** Large mandapams contain one hundred pillars as well as one thousand pillars in some big temples. The sculptures on the pillars were carved with distinctive features. The horse was the most common motif found on these pillars.
- **Statement 3 is incorrect:** The most important temples of the Vijayanagar style were found in the Hampi ruins or the city of Vijayanagar. Vittalaswami and Hazara Ramaswamy temples were the best examples of this style. The Varadharaja and Ekambaranatha temples at Kanchipuram stand as examples for the magnificence of the Vijayanagara style of temple architecture. Chennakesava temple in Belur is an example of Hoysala art.

Source: Dahiya(601) and Nitin singhaniya (1.33)

Q.46) Ans: C

Exp:

- **Firuz Shah Bahmani** encouraged the pursuit of astronomy and built an observatory near Daulatabad. He paid attention to the ports of his Kingdom, Chaul and Dabhol, which attracted trading ships from the Persian Gulf and the Red Sea.
- Firuz Shah Bahmani was determined to make Deccan the Cultural centre of India and the

decline of Delhi Sultanate helped him as many learned people migrated from Delhi to the Deccan. Further he was also well acquainted with natural sciences such as botany, geometry.

- He was also well acquainted with religious Sciences like commentaries on the Quran. He was a good calligraphist and a poet and often composed extempore verses.

Source: Satish Chandra (page 145-146)

Reference: Who among the following Mughal Emperors shifted emphasis from illustrated manuscripts to album and individual portrait

Q.47) Ans: C

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is incorrect:** The provincial governors had a large measure of autonomy. They held their own courts, appointed their own offices and maintained their own Armies. There was no regular term for a provincial governor, his term depending on his ability and his strength. They formed a very powerful section and sometimes it was difficult for the central authority to control them
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** Most of the travellers had little knowledge about village life and thus spoke of it in very general terms. There was very little idea about the share of the produce the peasants were required to pay and it varied according to the type of crops, method of irrigation and other factors.

Source: Satish Chandra(152)

Q.48) Ans: B

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is incorrect:** The Chola Tradition of village self government was **considerably weakened** under the Vijayanagar rule. The Kingdom was divided into mandalam(provinces), Nadu(District), Sthal(Sub-district) and gram(villages). The Governors of the Provinces had usurped a large measure of autonomy. They had their own courts, appointed their own officers and maintained their own Armies.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** Dharmasastras generally formed the basis on which cases were



decided. **Harsh punishments** were given in Vijayanagar Kingdom which included **decapitation, mutilation, throwing to elephants and imprisonment**. Prisoners were even flogged in public. Blows were administered with a whip and usually directed to a person's back. The harsh punishments were supposed to eradicate evil and act as a **deterrent to others**.

- **Statement 3 is correct:** Administration under Vijayanagara empire was well organised. The king enjoyed absolute authority in executive, judicial and legislative matters. He was the **highest court of appeal**. The king was assisted by the Council of Ministers in his day-to-day administration. The succession to the throne largely happened on the principle of hereditary.

Source: Satish Chandra(pg152) TN History(212-213)

Q.49) Ans: C

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** Land revenues were a major source of income to the government in Vijayanagar Kingdom. Besides these there were other taxes such as property tax, tax on sale of produce, profession taxes. military contribution (in times of distress), tax on marriage. Tributes and gifts from vassals and feudal chiefs and customs collected at the ports were other sources of income.
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** The expenditure of the state was divided into four parts. It was suggested in Krishna Deva Raya's work Amuktamalyada. The expenditure consisted of- charities and personal expenditure of the king, maintenance of horses, military conquests and security of the empire.
- **Statement 3 is incorrect:** The **Sangama rulers were chiefly Shaivite** and Virupaksha was their family deity. Other dynasties of Vijayanagar Kingdom were vaishnavite. All Kings were tolerant towards other religions. Barbosa referred to the religious freedom enjoyed by everyone.

Source: TN history(210-211) Satish Chandra(152-153)

Consider the following statements:

1. In the revenue administration of Delhi Sultanate, the in-charge of revenue collection was known as 'Amil'.
2. The Iqta system of Sultans of Delhi was an ancient indigenous institution.

3. The office of 'Mir Bakshi' came into existence during the reign of Khalji Sultans of Delhi.

Q.50) Ans: D

Exp:

- **Pair 1 is incorrect:** The Nayaks(or palegar) were top grade officers of the military. These officers maintained a fixed number of soldiers, horses and elephants for the service of the state. The Nayak also had to pay a sum of money to the central exchequer.
- **Pair 2 is correct:** The Nayaks were granted lands in lieu of their services. These lands were called Amaram. These grants were limited to top officers and soldiers were usually paid in cash with these officers. The nayaka were responsible for expanding agricultural activities in his amaram (area). They were also responsible for tax collection in this area.
- **Pair 3 is correct:** There were numerous industries in the Vijayanagar Empire. It was also a great centre of trade. Metal workers and other crafts flourished during the period. Number of sea ports were located on the Malabar Coast, the chief being Cannanore. The chief gold coin to be used in the Empire was called Varaha. Inland, coastal, and overseas trade led to general prosperity.

Source: TN history(213) and Satish Chandra(152)

Q.51) Ans: C

Exp:

- **Option 1 is correct:** **Fernao Nuniz** was from **Portugal**. He visited Vijayanagar Kingdom during the rule of Achyut Devraya. According to Nuniz, a large number of women were employed in royal palaces as dancers, domestic servants and palanquin bearers. Nuniz also provided a description of the Sati system in society. He also mentioned excavation of canals and irrigation facilities.
- **Option 2 is correct:** **Paes** was also from **Portugal**. He visited the Vijayanagar Kingdom during the rule of Krishnadevaraya. Paes mentioned the beautiful houses of the rich and the large number of Their household servants. Paes also refers to the flourishing devadasi system in the kingdom.



- **Option 3 is correct:** Barbosa also visited Vijayanagar Kingdom during the rule of Krishnadevaraya. He was also from Portugal. Barbosa referred to the religious freedom enjoyed by everyone. They were vegetarians and so were the Virasaivas who wore the symbol of their god round their neck. Other castes like Vaishyas and Sudras were also there. Jains also formed an important section of the population.

Source: NCERT and kishan reddy (page: 1323)

Q.52) Ans: B

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is incorrect:** Srinatha was a noted poet of Telugu Language. He was honored with the title Kavisarvabhauma ("Emperor among Poets' ") by Dev Raya II. The king showed his appreciation with a kanakabhisheka ceremony (the "showering of gold coins on the head"). Dindima was a well-known poet during this time in Dev Raya II's Court who was defeated by Srinatha. Srinatha is known to have lived a life of pleasure and moved on equal terms with the ministers in the king's court.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** Madhura, a noted Jain poet, was in the court of Deva Raya I (and also in the court of his father King Harihara II). He wrote the Dharmanathapurana on the life of the 15th Jain Tirthankar in Kannada. He has also wrote a poem in eulogy of Gomateshwara in Shravanabelagola.(592-dahiya)
- **Statement 3 is incorrect:** Eight eminent scholars known as Ashtadiggajas were present at the royal court of Krishna Deva Raya. Allasani Peddanna was the considered greatest among them and he was called AndhraKavita Pitamaha. His important works include Manucharitam and Harikathasaram. Pingali Suranna and Tenali Ramakrishna were other important scholars in court of Krihsna Deva Raya.

Source: Dahiya (594) and TN History

Q.53) Ans: B

Exp:

- **Ibn Battuta's** book of travels, called Rihla, written in Arabic, provides extremely rich and interesting details about the social and cultural life in the subcontinent in the fourteenth century. Travelling overland through Central Asia, Ibn Battuta reached Sind in 1333. during the reign of the Tughlaq dynasty. Ibn Battuta has travelled extensively and has even mentioned about-the coconut and paan(betel leaf).
- **Nicolo Conti** Was from Italy who visited Vijayanagar Kingdom during the reign of Devraya I (1406-1422). Conti refers to the prevalence of slavery in society. He also inferred that dancing, music, wrestling, gambling and cock-fighting were some of the amusements of the society.
- **Domingo Paes** was from Portugal. He visited the Vijayanagar Kingdom during the rule of Krishnadevaraya (1509-1529). Paes mentioned the beautiful houses of the rich and the large number of Their household servants. Paes also refers to the flourishing devadasi system in the kingdom.
- **Fernao Nuniz** was from Portugal. He visited Vijayanagar Kingdom during the rule of Achyut Devraya (1529-1542). According to Nuniz, a large number of women were employed in royal palaces as dancers, domestic servants and palanquin bearers. Nuniz also provided a description of the Sati system in society. He also mentioned excavation of canals and irrigation facilities.

Source: NCERT and TN History and hemes in INdia history pge 118)

Q.54) Ans: A

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** Mohammed Quli Qutub Shah was the greatest ruler of the Qutub Shahi dynasty. He founded the city of Hyderabad originally known as Bhagyanagar after the name of sultan's favourite wife Bhagyamati. He also built the famous Charminar.
- **Statement 2 is incorrect** - Gol Gumbaz was built by Mohammed Adil Shah which is famous for its whispering gallery Construction of the tomb, located in Bijapur(Karnataka) was started in 1626 and was completed in 1656. The name is based on "Gol Gumbad" derived from "Gola Gummata" meaning "circular dome". It follows the style of

Indo-Islamic architecture. Even a slight whisper by someone standing in its gallery can be heard everywhere else in the gallery, and if somebody claps, the sound of it echoes several times. It is built in **dark grey basalt**.

Source: Lucent (57)

Q.55) Ans: A

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** The **Tuluva Dynasty** was founded by **Vira Narsimha**. It was the third important dynasty to rule Vijayanagar after the Sangama and Saluva dynasty. **Krishnadeva Raya** was an important ruler of this dynasty. He defeated the Muslim armies in the Battle of Diwani and captured the city of Raichur in 1520 after defeating the Sultan of Bijapur, Ismail Adil Shah. He was a great patron of literature and appointed eight eminent scholars referred to as **Ashtadiggajas** in his court. **Ashtapradhan** were the council of ministers appointed by **Shivaji** to carry on his administration. Each minister was responsible for different departments and was responsible to Shivaji. These ministers were **Peshwa** (Prime Minister); **Senapati** (Military commander); **Amatya** (Accountant General); **Waqenavis** (Intelligence); **Sachiv** (correspondence); **Sumanta** (ceremonies); **Nyayadish** (Justice); and **Panditrao** (religious administration).
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** The **Battle of Talikota** was fought in 1565 between the combined armies of the Bijapur, Golkonda, Ahmadnagar, and Bidar with **Rama Raya** of the Tuluva Dynasty who was defeated and this led to the decline of the Vijayanagara Empire.

Source: TN pg: 211, 210, 251, 212

Q.56) Ans: C

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is incorrect:** **Virupaksha Temple** was built by **Lakkan Dandesha**, a nayaka under Sangama dynasty ruler, **Deva Raya II**. Virupaksha Temple is an example of the Vijayanagar school. This school of architecture is characterized by the

presence of: Gopurams, monolith rock pillars, Kalyan Mandapam, etc.

- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** **Raichur Doab** was a triangular region of fertile land, between **Krishna** and its tributary **Tungabhadra**. It remained a bone of contention for several years between the Vijayanagar and the Bahmani kingdoms.
- **Statement 3 is incorrect:** **Battle of Diwani** was a decisive battle fought between **Krishnadeva Raya** and **Sultan of Bijapur, Ismail Adil Shah**. It established the dominance of Vijayanagara kingdom in this region.
- **Statement 4 is correct:** The temple architecture of this period was marked by the construction of a large number of pillars. **Kalyan Mandapam** was an important part of the temples where the idol of the chief deity was placed. Large mandapams were constructed with hundreds and thousands of pillars. Horses were the most common animal depicted in these pillars.
- **Statement 5 is correct:** **Krishnadeva Raya** was great patronage of literature, he himself was proficient litterateur in both Telugu and Sanskrit. He was also known as Andhra Bhoja. He authored a Telugu work, **Amuktamalyada** and Sanskrit works, **Jambavati Kalyanam** and **Ushaparinaya**.

Source: TN pg 210,211,215

Q.57) Ans: C

Exp:

- **Option C is correct:** **Mahmud Gawan** was not the king, but chief minister during the rule of Muhammad Shah III. He came to India as a Persian merchant, but slowly rose because of his qualities and due to his reforms, he transformed the Bahmani kingdom to its glory. **Zafar Khan** was the actual name of founder of Bahmani kingdom, and he was a noble under Muhammad Tughlaq. He is also known by the name of **Hasan Gangau**. The capital was shifted from Gulbarga to Bidar in 1429 under the rule of **Ahmad Shah Wali**. Persian Indo-Islamic architecture was developed during the rule of the Bahmani kingdom. **Gulbarga Fort, Bidar Fort, Mahmud Gawan madrasa** are examples of notable Bahmani architecture which influenced the Deccan sultanates too.



Source: TN pg: 216, 217

Q.58) Ans: D

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is Correct** : Though an orthodox Sunni, Babar was neither bigoted and nor led by religious divines. He was a devoted follower of Naqshbandiya Sufi Khwaja Ubaidullah Ahrar.
- **Statement 2 is Incorrect** : He was deeply learned in Persian and Arabic, and is regarded as one of the two most famous writers of his mother tongue, Turkish. Indeed he wrote a memoir in Turkish called Tuzuk-i-Babri/Babur Nama (translated into Persian by Abdur Rahim Khan-i-Khana) and also wrote Masnavi.
- **Statement 3 is Correct** : He also introduced Char-Baghs and symmetrically laid out gardens with running waters and fountains. Charbagh is a Persian quadrilateral garden layout based on the four gardens representing the Islamic ideal of paradise. The quadrilateral garden is divided by walkways or flowing water into four smaller parts. They are found in countries throughout Western Asia and South Asia, including Iran and India. In India, the Char Bagh concept is epitomised in Humayun's Tomb (Delhi) and Taj Mahal (Agra).

Source : Poonam Dahiya (654-55)

Q.59) Ans: D

Exp:

- **Statement 1 & 2 is Correct** : Akbar introduced the **Mansabdari** system in his administration. Under this system, every officer (Mansabdar) was assigned a rank (mansab). The lowest rank was 10 and the highest was 5,000 for the nobles. Princes of royal blood received even higher ranks. For instance, Raja Man Singh and Mirza Aziz Koka were honoured with the rank of 7,000 each. The mansab rank was not hereditary. All appointments and promotions as well as dismissals were directly made by the emperor.
- **Statement 3 is Correct** : The **Jagirdari system**, that is to say the system of assignment of revenue of a particular territory to the nobles for their services to the state, was an integral part of the Mansabdari system. There were various types of jagirs:

- **Tankha Jagirs**: Which were given in lieu of salaries and they were transferable every three to four years.
- **Mashrut Jagirs**: Which were given on certain conditions
- **Watan Jagirs**: Which were assigned to zamindar or rajas in their local dominions. Watan Jagirs were hereditary and non-transferable. When a zamindar was made a Mansabdar, he was given Tankha Jagir apart from his Watan Jagir at another place, if the salary of his rank was more than the income from his Watan Jagir.
- **Altamgha Jagirs**: Which were given to Muslim nobles in their family towns or place of birth.

Q.60) Ans: A

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is Correct** : The land revenue system adopted by Akbar was largely based on Sher Shah's system but with slight modifications and was called **Zabti or Bandobast system**, which was further improved by Raja Todar Mal. Under this system, Todar Mal introduced a uniform system of land measurement, classification of land, and fixation of rates. The revenue was one third of the average produce and was paid mostly in cash. In c.1580 CE, Akbar introduced the **Dahsala System** under which revenue was fixed on the average yield of land assessed on the basis of past ten years (dah years).
- **Statement 2 is Incorrect** : The land was divided into four categories –
 - **Polaj** (cultivated every year)
 - **Parati** (fallow, once in two years): Parati land paid at the full polaj rate when it was cultivated.
 - **Chachar** (once in three or four years)
 - **Banjar** (once in five or more years).
chachar and banjar were assessed at concessional rates.
- **Statement 3 is Incorrect** : The peasants who owned the land they tilled were called Khudkasht who paid land revenue at customary rates.

Source : Poonam Dahiya (680-81)

Q.61) Ans: D



Exp:

- **Statement 1 is Correct** : The Mughals retained many features of the administrative system of the Sultanate and Sher Shah Suri's administration. The administration was highly centralised and the territories of the empire were divided into Jagir, Khalsa (income went directly to the royal exchequer), and Inam (lands allowed to learned and religious men).
- **Statement 2 is Correct** : The Emperor was the supreme head of the administration and controlled all military and judicial powers. All officers in Mughal administration owed their power and position to the Emperor. The Emperor had authority to appoint, promote, and remove officials at his pleasure.
- **Statement 3 is Correct** : Akbar reorganised the central machinery of administration on the basis of the division of power between various departments, and of checks and balances. In his determination to curb the powers of the wazir, he took away the financial powers from him, which was a big jolt to the wazir's power.

Source : Poonam Dahiya (675-76)

Q.62) Ans: B

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is Incorrect** : Akbar built the Jahangiri Mahal in Agra fort, according to Hindu design based on Man Mandir. Panch Mahal was built in Fatehpur Sikri which has five storeys built in the plan of Buddhist vihara.
- **Statement 2 is Incorrect** : In c.1572 CE, Akbar advanced on Ahmedabad via Ajmer and defeated the Gujarat ruler Muzaffar Shah without any serious resistance. It was in order to commemorate the victory of Gujarat that Akbar built the Buland Darwaza at Fatehpur Sikri. Surat, with a strong fortress, offered some resistance but was also captured. In a short time, most of the principalities of Gujarat were brought under his control.
- **Statement 3 is Correct** : One of Akbar's most notable achievements was that, in spite of the subjugation of the whole of Rajasthan, there was no hostility between the Rajputs and the Mughals. Akbar's Rajput policy was combined with a broad religious tolerance.

- He abolished the pilgrim tax (c.1563 CE) and later the jizya (c.1564 CE). He also prohibited forcible conversion of prisoners of war. It is noteworthy to add that the Rajput policy of Akbar proved to be beneficial to the Mughal state as well as to the Rajputs.
- The alliance on one hand secured the services of the bravest warriors to the Mughals whereas on the other hand, it ensured peace in Rajasthan and many Rajput mansabdars were assigned their own territories as Watan Jagir, which was hereditary and non-transferable. They also rose to important positions in Mughal services.

Source - Poonam Dahiya (667-73)

Q.63) Ans: B

Exp:

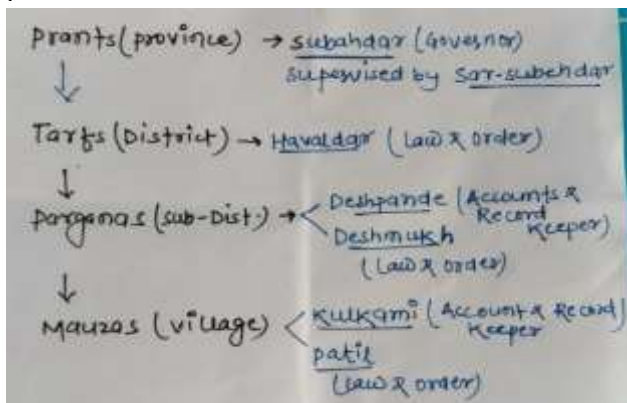
- **Statement 1 is Incorrect** : Sources of the seventeenth century refer to two kinds of peasants – **khud-kashta** and **pahi-kashta**. The former were residents of the village in which they held their lands. The latter were non-resident cultivators who belonged to some other village, but cultivated lands elsewhere on a contractual basis.
- **Statement 2 is Correct** : Mughal imperial society combined personnel as well as material and cultural elements drawn widely from circuits of mobility in India. Turkish influence was also important in revenue administration, beginning with Timur's adaptation of iqta assignments of land to support military commanders, which the Ottomans and the Delhi Sultans adapted.

Source : NCERT (Themes in Indian History) + Krishna Reddy (Page no 1484-90)

Q.64) Ans: B

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is Incorrect** : Maratha's Provincial and Local administration was based largely on the Deccani and Mughal system. Following was the hierarchy in the provincial and local administration -



- **Statement 2 is Correct** : Shivaji drastically reduced the powers of the existing Deshmukhs and Kulkarnis and appointed his own revenue officials called karkuns. Shivaji strongly discouraged revenue farming.
- **Statement 3 is Correct** : The Marathas employed a special script known as the 'Modi script' in the documents of the revenue and administrative records.

Source - Poonam Dahiya (744-46)

Q.65) Ans: D

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is Correct** : Though an orthodox Sunni, he was neither bigoted and nor led by religious divines. He was a devoted follower of Naqshbandiya Sufi Khwaja Ubaidullah Ahrar.
- **Statement 2 is Incorrect** : He was deeply learned in Persian and Arabic, and is regarded as one of the two most famous writers of his mother tongue, Turkish. Indeed he wrote a memoir in Turkish called Tuzuk-i-Babri/Babur Nama (translated into Persian by Abdur Rahim Khan-i-Khana) and also wrote Masnavi.
- **Statement 3 is Correct** : He also Introduced Char-Baghs and symmetrically laid out gardens with running waters and fountains. Charbagh is a Persian quadrilateral garden layout based on the four gardens representing the Islamic ideal of paradise. The quadrilateral garden is divided by walkways or flowing water into four smaller parts. They are found in countries throughout Western Asia and South Asia, including Iran and India. In India, the Char Bagh concept is epitomised in Humayun's Tomb (Delhi) and Taj Mahal (Agra).

Source : Poonam Dahiya (654-55)

Q.66) Ans: A

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is Correct** : With the advent of Islam, new forces appeared on the Indian horizon. Strict veiling of women was the common practice among the Muslims in their native land. Naturally in a foreign country like India, greater stress was laid upon it. The Hindus adopted purdah as a protective measure. The tendency to imitate the ruling class was another factor which operated in favour of introducing purdah among the Hindu families. Seclusion thus became a sign of respect and was strictly observed among the high-class families of both communities. Barring some notable Muslim families, the south Indians did not adopt purdah. In the Vijayanagar Empire, purdah was confined only to the members of the royal household. No such coercive purdah system was observed among the Hindu middle classes.
- **Statement 2 is Incorrect** : Monogamy seems to have been the rule among the lower stratum of society in both communities during the medieval period. Akbar had issued definite orders that a man of ordinary means should not possess more than one wife unless the first proved to be barren. Polygamy was the privilege of the rich.

Source : Krishna Reddy (1492-93)

Q.67) Ans: B

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is Incorrect** : Sher Shah, even though a pious Muslim, adopted a tolerant attitude towards other religions. He employed Hindus in important offices.
 - His last campaign was against Kalinjar (Bundelkhand), in which he succeeded but died from an accidental explosion of gunpowder in c.1545 CE
- **Statement 2 is Correct** : The system of tri-metalism which came to characterise Mughal coinage was largely the creation, not of the Mughals but of Sher Shah Suri (1540 to 1545 AD), an Afghan, who ruled for a brief time in Delhi. Sher Shah issued a coin of silver which was termed the Rupiya. This weighed 178 grains and was the precursor of the modern rupee. It remained largely unchanged till the early 20th Century. Together with the silver Rupiya were issued gold



coins called the Mohur weighing 169 grains and copper coins called Dam.

- **Statement 3 is Incorrect** : Sher shah suri was a patron of art and architecture. He built many forts and mosques among other architecture.
 - He built the Rohtas Fort (now a UNESCO World Heritage Site in Pakistan)
 - He built Many structures in Rohtasgarh fort in Bihar.

Source - Poonam Dahiya (659-60) + RBI

website, [Source](#)

https://m.rbi.org.in/scripts/mc_mughal.aspx

Q.68) Ans: A

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is Correct** : Under the administration of Sher Shah Suri, the government was highly centralised and consisted of several departments. There were also many administrative units called iqtas. The king was assisted by four important ministers:
 - **Diwan-i- Wizarat** – Also called Wazir, in charge of Revenue and Finance.
 - **Diwan-i-Ariz** – In charge of the Army.
 - **Diwan-i-Rasalat** – Foreign Minister
 - **Diwan-i-Insha** – Minister for Communications.
- **Statement 2 is Correct** : He improved the land revenue system by adopting Zabti-i-har-sal (land assessment every year) and classified all cultivable lands into three heads (good, middle, bad).
- **Statement 3 is Incorrect** : The state's share was one third of the average produce and it was paid in cash or crop. Land was measured using Sikandari gaz (32 points). Sher Shah introduced two documents:
 - **Patta** (amount each peasant had to pay)
 - **Qabuliyat** (Deed of agreement).Sher Shah also introduced new copper coins called Dam and it is interesting to note that they were in circulation till c.1835 CE. He was also the first ruler to introduce silver Rupaiya (1 Rupaiya = 64 dams) and gold coin (Ashrafi/Mohur)

Source : Poonam Dahiya (660-661)

Q.69) Ans: C

Exp:

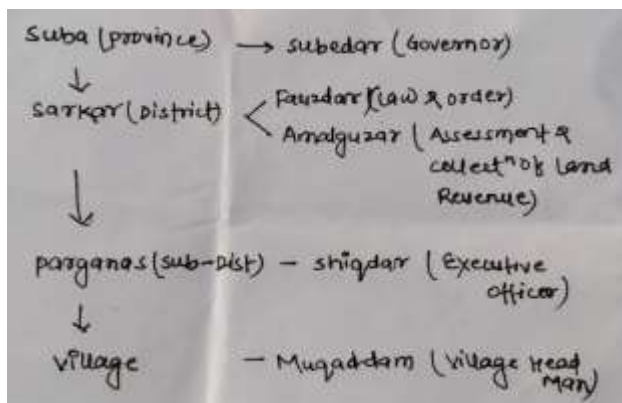
- **Statement 1 is Correct** : During the medieval period Indian society was divided into two broad divisions based on religion. In English documents and records of the period the Hindus are referred to as '**Gentoos**' (Gentiles) and the Muslims as '**Moors**'. The two communities differed with respect to social manners and etiquette; even their forms of salutation were different. They differed in the respect of dress and diet too. Each community had its own religious festivals. The social rites and ceremonies of the two communities, on occasions of birth and marriage, for instance, were different
- **Statement 2 & 3 is Correct** : The overwhelming majority of the Muslims were descendants of Hindu converts; but there was a tendency on their part to claim foreign descent with a view to securing political and social advantages. They were generally looked down upon by bona fide Turanians and Iranians; but they were received on equal terms in mosques during the Friday prayers and also on occasions of principal religious festivals. There was no bar to inter-marriage on racial grounds. A Muslim of low birth could rise to a high rank in the nobility by dint of ability or through the favour of fortune. The Muslim society had far greater internal mobility than the Hindu society.

Source : Krishna Reddy (1490-92)

Q.70) Ans: C

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is Correct** : The Mughal empire was divided into twelve subas or provinces by Akbar. These were Allahabad, Agra, Awadh, Ajmer, Ahmedabad, Bihar, Bengal, Delhi, Kabul, Lahore, Malwa, and Multan. Later on Ahmednagar, Berar, and Khandesh were added. With the expansion of Mughal empire, the number of provinces increased to twenty. The division was as (shown in fig)



Q.72) Ans: C

Exp:

- G-33 is a **group of developing countries established prior to 2003** at the **Cancun Ministerial conference** to negotiate on agricultural trade and tariffs with the WTO.
- They are also called as **Friends of Special Products in Agriculture**. The group is **dominated by India** and also includes other members like China, Pakistan, Zimbabwe, Cuba, etc.
- The G-33 has been supporting the developing countries that maintain public stockholding for food security purposes. The group has argued that the limits on subsidies imposed by the WTO's Agreement on Agriculture should not constrain countries from providing subsidised food to the poor.
- Currently, a temporary truce prevails under which even if a **member breaches the subsidy limit, i.e. 10% of the value of agricultural production, no dispute would be initiated against the member**.
- Recently India proposed for an amendment with reference to -
 - Public Stockholding policy tool used by governments to be considered as part of Green box.
 - Food security programs to be exempted from subsidy reduction commitments of WTO.

Reference: <https://www.newindianexpress.com/opinions/columns/2021/aug/13/agri-exports-from-india-rise-but-can-this-last-2343936.html>

Q.73) Ans: A

Exp:

About PENCIL

- PENCIL (**Platform for Effective Enforcement of No Child Labour**) is an electronic platform that aims to **involve Center, State, District and civil societies** in achieving the target of child labour free society.
- It has been launched by **Ministry of Labour and Employment's National Child Labour Project in 2017**, for eradication of child labour. PENCIL has following components -
 - Child Tracking System
 - Complaint Corner
 - State Government

- **Statement 2 is Correct** : The port administration was independent of the provincial authority. The governor of the port was called Mutasaddi who was directly appointed by the Emperor. Mutasaddi collected taxes on merchandise and maintained a customs house. He also supervised the mint house at the port

Q.71) Ans: B

Exp:

- Desertification and Land Degradation Atlas of India is published by Space Application Centre, **ISRO**, Ahmedabad. The Atlas provides a **state wise area of degraded lands for the time frame 2018-19**. It also provides the change analysis for the duration of 15 years, from 2003-05 to 2018-19.
- The recent Atlas was released on the occasion of the **World Day to Combat Desertification and Drought (17 June)**. The theme for 2021 is **"Restoration. Land. Recovery. We build back better with healthy land"**.
- India hosted the **14th session of Conference of Parties (COP 14) of United Nations Convention to Combat Desertification (UNCCD)** in September 2019.
- India is striving towards achieving the national commitments of **Land Degradation Neutrality (LDN)** and **restoration of 26 Million ha of degraded land by 2030** which focus on sustainable and optimum utilisation of land resources.

Reference

: <https://pib.gov.in/PressReleaseIframePage.aspx?PRID=1727987>



- National Child Labour Project and
- Convergence.
- Complaints about child labour filed on PENCIL are forwarded to the **district nodal officer** for further action. Each district nominates a district nodal officer (DNO) who checks if the complaint is genuine. If yes, rescue measures are undertaken in coordination with police.

National Child Labour Project

- It is a **Central sector scheme** launched in 1988 and has the basic objective of suitably **rehabilitating the children withdrawn from employment** thereby **reducing the incidence of child labour** in areas of known concentration of child labour.
- Under this Scheme, Of the children identified those in the **age group 5-8 years** will have to be mainstreamed directly to the formal educational system through the SSA. Working children in the **age group of 9- 14 years will have to be rehabilitated through NCLP schools** established by the Project Society.
- The entire project is required to be **implemented** through a **registered society under the Chairmanship of administrative head of the district**, namely, District Magistrate/Collector/Dy.

Reference: <https://vikaspedia.in/social-welfare/women-and-child-development/child-development-1/platform-for-effective-enforcement-for-no-child-labour>

Q.74) Ans: D

Exp:

- **Current Situation Index** also known as **Present Situation Index** is released by RBI . It is an indicator of consumer sentiments about current business and job markets. Business, investors and policymakers use the index to gauge consumer demand.
- The survey is conducted through field interviews wherever possible and telephonic interviews elsewhere by **RBI** in **major cities** like Bangalore, Chennai, Delhi etc.
- CSI and FEI are compiled on the basis of net responses on the **economic situation, income, spending, employment and the price level** for

the current period and a year ahead, respectively.

- **Future Expectations Index** - An index value below 100 represents pessimism, while that above 100 signals optimism.

Reference:

<https://www.investopedia.com/terms/p/presentsituationindex.asp>

Q.75) Ans: D

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is incorrect:** EnVision is an **ESA led mission with contributions from NASA** to Venus to study its **atmosphere and analyse its surface composition**. It is likely to be launched sometime in the 2030s using the **Ariane 6 rocket**. EnVision will follow another ESA-led mission to Venus called 'Venus Express' (2005-2014) that focussed on atmospheric research and pointed to volcanic hotspots on the planet's surface.
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** Venus was the first ever planet to be explored by a spacecraft (Russia's Venera 1 in 1961). Japan's Akatsuki spacecraft has also been studying the planet's atmosphere since 2015. NASA recently announced two missions Probe DAVINCI+ and VERITAS.
 - **DAVINCI**, which stands for Deep Atmosphere Venus Investigation of Noble gases, Chemistry, and Imaging, will gather more detail on the **composition of Venus' atmosphere** to learn how it formed and evolved. The mission also seeks to determine whether the planet once had an ocean.
 - **VERITAS** (Venus Emissivity, Radio Science, InSAR, Topography, and Spectroscopy) will aim to map the Venusian surface from orbit and delve into the planet's geologic history.
- India is developing a potential Venus mission - **Shukrayaan-1** is a proposed orbiter to Venus to be launched in 2024 or 2026.



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- Venus is the second closest planet to the Sun, orbiting at a distance of about 67 million miles. It falls under the habitable zone of the Sun.
- Venus has a **thick, toxic atmosphere** filled with carbon dioxide and at 850 degrees Fahrenheit, it is the **hottest planet in the solar system**. It has a crushing air pressure and is perpetually shrouded in thick, yellowish clouds of sulphuric acid. Venus' thick atmosphere traps heat creating a greenhouse effect.
- It is often referred to as **Earth's twin**. Both the planets are almost alike in size, density and gravity. Venus rotates very slowly on its axis – one day on Venus lasts 243 Earth days. **The planet orbits the Sun faster than Earth.**
- Venus rotates backward on its axis. This means the **Sun rises in the west and sets in the east**, opposite of what we see on Earth.
- The **surface of Venus is dominated by volcanic features** and has **more volcanoes than any other planet in the Solar System**.

Reference:

<https://www.thehindu.com/children/explained-nasas-missions-to-venus/article34863589.ece>

Q.76) Ans: D

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is incorrect:** Tulu is a 2000 year old Dravidian language spoken mainly in coastal districts of Karnataka (Udupi and Dakshina Kannada) and Kerala (Kasargod). The Tulu speakers, mainly in Karnataka and Kerala, have been requesting the governments to give it official language status and include it in the eighth schedule to the Constitution. Assamese, Bengali, Gujarati, Hindi, Kannada, Kashmiri, Konkani, Malayalam, Manipuri, Marathi, Nepali, Oriya, Punjabi, Sanskrit, Sindhi, Tamil, Telugu, Urdu, Bodo, Santhali, Maithili and Dogri are the **22 languages presently in the eighth schedule to the Constitution**.
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** Tulu is not an official language in the country. Efforts are being made

to include Tulu in the eighth schedule of the Constitution. **If included in the eighth schedule, Tulu would get recognition from the Sahitya Akademi.** Efforts are being made by bodies like "Jai Tulunad" and online campaigns like #Education in Tulu to get it official recognition.

- **Statement 3 is incorrect: NEP 2020 currently does not allow Tulu as a third language.** However, the Karnataka Government recently allowed students to opt Tulu as a 3rd language in SSLC exams. Tulu has a rich oral literature tradition with folk-song forms like paddana, and traditional folk theatre yakshagana.

Reference: <https://www.thehindu.com/opinion/op-ed/a-case-for-including-tulu-in-the-eighth-schedule/article30496165.ece>

Q.77) Ans: B

Exp:

- India along with the Govt. of United Kingdom launched a new workstream to promote industrial energy efficiency under the Clean Energy Ministerial's (CEM) – Industrial Deep Decarbonization Initiative (IDDI) co-ordinated by UNIDO , at the 12th Chief Energy Ministerial (CEM).
- It is coordinated by the United Nations Industrial Development Organization (UNIDO).
- The IDDI initiative has been supported by Germany and Canada, with more countries expected to join soon. The objective is to infuse green technologies and stimulate demand for low-carbon industrial material.

Source:

<https://pib.gov.in/PressReleasePage.aspx?PRID=1723981>

Q.78) Ans: A

Exp:

- **PMI or a Purchasing Managers' Index (PMI) is an indicator of business activity** -- both in the manufacturing and services sectors. It is a survey-based measure that asks the respondents about changes in their perception of some key business variables from the month before. It is **calculated separately for the manufacturing and services**



sectors and then a composite index is constructed.

- The purpose of the PMI is to provide information about current and future business conditions to company decision makers, analysts, and investors.
- It consists of a diffusion index that summarizes whether market conditions, as viewed by purchasing managers, are expanding, staying the same, or contracting. **A figure above 50 denotes expansion** in business activity. Anything **below 50 denotes contraction**. Higher the difference from this mid-point greater the expansion or contraction.
- The PMI is calculated by taking the weighted average of the following five indices: New Orders (30%), Output (25%), Employment (20%), Supplier Delivery Times (15%) and Stocks of items Purchased (10%)
- The PMI data is **compiled by IHS Markit** for more than 40 economies worldwide and is usually released at the start of every month and is considered a good leading indicator of economic activity.

Source: The Hindu.

Q.79) Ans: B

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is incorrect :** The challenge was launched last year under the Smart Cities Mission by the Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs on 25th June, 2020, as a response to the COVID-19 pandemic that was gaining ground in the country.
- **Statement 2 is correct :** To inspire Indian cities to implement quick cycling-friendly interventions in the wake of Covid-19 with the support of their citizens and assistance from experts. As the COVID-19 pandemic was making inroads across the country, cycling saw a huge rise in demand. The lockdown restrictions had significantly affected the commuters of public transport, who saw cycling as a personal and COVID-safe alternative for short and medium distance commute. Moreover, cycling was also seen as a means of staying healthy- physically and mentally by the people who were confined to their homes.

Source:

<https://pib.gov.in/PressReleaseframePage.aspx?PRID=1723860>

Q.80) Ans: B

Exp:

SDG India Index

- The index is **developed in collaboration with the United Nations in India**. It was launched in December 2018 and it's primary tool for **monitoring progress on the SDGs in India**.
- It tracks the progress of all states and UTs on **115 indicators** aligned with the National Indicator Framework (NIF) of the Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation.
- It covered 13 Goals with 62 indicators in its first edition in 2018 and in the latest third edition of the index it covered **16 Goals on 115 quantitative indicators**.
- The SDG India Index scores range between **0–100, higher the score of a State/UT, the greater the distance to target achieved**. States and UTs are classified in four categories based on their SDG India Index score —
 - Aspirant: 0–49
 - Performer: 50–64
 - Front-Runner: 65–99
 - Achiever: 100
- Recently, The third edition of the **SDG India Index, 2020 and Dashboard 2020–21 was released by NITI Aayog**. NITI Aayog has the twin mandate to oversee the adoption and monitoring of the SDGs in the country, and also promote competitive and cooperative federalism among States and UTs.

SDG India Index 2020

- The country's overall SDG score improved by 6 points — from 60 in 2019 to 66 in 2020-21 — on accounts of improvement in performance in providing facilities including clean water and sanitation, affordable and clean energy among others.

Top 5 positions		Bottom 5 positions	
State	Score	State	Score
Kerala	75	Chhattisgarh,	61
Himachal Pradesh,	74	Nagaland, Odisha	
Tamil Nadu		Arunachal Pradesh,	60
Andhra Pradesh, Goa,	72	Meghalaya, Rajasthan,	
Karnataka, Uttarakhand		Uttar Pradesh	
Sikkim	71	Assam	57
Maharashtra	70	Jharkhand	56
		Bihar	52

- While **Kerala retained its rank as the top** with a score of 75, Himachal Pradesh and Tamil Nadu both took the second spot with a score of 74. Bihar, Jharkhand and Assam were the worst performing states in this year's India index.
- Currently, there are no states in the aspirant and achiever category.

Source:

<https://pib.gov.in/PressReleasePage.aspx?PRID=1723952>

Q.81) Ans: A

Exp:

"Glaciers of the Himalayas: Climate Change, Black Carbon and Regional Resilience" report

- It is released by the World Bank and covers the Himalaya, Karakoram, and Hindu Kush (HKHK) mountain ranges.

Key Findings of the report

- Black carbon deposits originating from factories, cooking and vehicles are compounding the effects of climate change to speed up the melting of the Himalayan glaciers. Deposits of BC act in two ways hastening the pace of glacier melt: by decreasing surface reflectance of sunlight and by raising air temperature.
- Full implementation of current policies to mitigate BC can achieve a 23% reduction but enacting new policies and incorporating them through regional cooperation among countries can achieve enhanced benefits
- Melting glaciers and loss of seasonal snow pose significant risks not just to the people who live at their feet but to the stability of water resources in the South Asia region more broadly.

Source:

<https://www.thehindu.com/sci-tech/energy-and-environment/strong-policies-on-black-carbon-can-sharply-cut-glacier-melt-says-world-bank-study/article34719913.ece>
<https://www.worldbank.org/en/news/press-release/2021/06/01/to-slow-himalayan-glacier-melt-curbing-air-pollution-is-key>

Q.82) Ans: B

Exp:

- The **Indian SARS-CoV-2 Genomics Consortium (INSACOG)** is a **national multi-agency consortium of Genome Sequencing Laboratories (RGLs)**, established by the Government of India on 30th December 2020.
- INSACOG is established **to expand whole genome sequencing of SARS-CoV-2 virus** across the nation, aiding our understanding of how the virus spreads and evolves.
- Initially, this consortium had 10 laboratories. Subsequently, the scope of laboratories under INSACOG was expanded and at present there are 28 laboratories under this Consortium which monitor the genomic variations in SARS-CoV-2.
- INSACOG has the following specific objectives:
 - To ascertain the status of Variants of Interest (VoI) and Variants of Concern (VoC) in the country
 - To establish sentinel surveillance and surge surveillance mechanisms for early detection of genomic variants and assist in formulating effective public health response
 - To determine the presence of genomic variants in samples collected during super-spreader events and in areas reporting increasing trend of cases/deaths etc.

Source:

<https://pib.gov.in/PressReleaseframePage.aspx?PRID=1707177>

Q.83) Ans: C

Exp:

- The **Interpol** has launched a new global database named **"I-Familia"** to identify missing persons



through family DNA and help the police solve cold cases in member countries.

- The database seeks to identify missing persons or unidentified human remains when direct comparison is not possible, by using DNA samples from family members instead.
- I-Familia has three components: a dedicated global database to host the DNA profiles provided by relatives, held separately from any criminal data; DNA matching software called **Bonaparte**, developed by Dutch company Smart Research; and interpretation guidelines developed by Interpol.

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About INTERPOL

- The International Criminal Police Organization is an international organization that facilitates worldwide police cooperation and crime control.
- It was **founded in September 1923** as the International Criminal Police Commission. It is **Headquartered in Lyon, France** and has **194 member countries**.
- India has been a member since 1956. Like any member nation, India maintains a National Central Bureau which serves as the national platform for cooperation between domestic law enforcement units and the international police community.
- There are **seven types of notices issued by INTERPOL**—
 - **Red Notice** - A Red Notice is a request to locate and provisionally arrest an individual pending extradition.
 - **Yellow Notice** - A Yellow Notice is issued to help locate missing persons, often minors, or to help identify persons who are unable to identify themselves.
 - **The Blue Notice** - It is issued to "collect additional information about a person's identity, location or activities in relation to a crime."
 - **Black Notice** - A Black Notice is a request to seek information on unidentified bodies in member nations.
 - **Green Notice** - A Green Notice is issued to provide warnings and intelligence about persons who have committed criminal offences and are likely to repeat these crimes in other countries.
 - **Orange Notice** - An Orange Notice is issued to provide warnings about an event, a person, an object or a process representing a serious and imminent threat to public safety.
 - **Purple Notice** - A Purple Notice is a request to seek or provide information on the modus operandi, objects, devices and concealment methods used by criminals.

Source: <https://www.thehindu.com/news/national/global-database-to-identify-missing-persons-launched/article34740859.ece>

Q.84) Ans: B

Exp:

About Burkina Faso

- **Burkina Faso** is a landlocked country in West Africa and is bordered by Mali to the northwest, Niger to the northeast, Benin to the southeast, Togo and Ghana to the south, and the Ivory Coast to the southwest.



- Burkina Faso lies mostly between latitudes 9° and 15° N, and longitudes 6° W and 3° E. The country is situated in the **Sahel region**. Burkina Faso has a primarily tropical climate with two very distinct seasons. In the rainy season, the country receives between 600 and 900 mm of rainfall; in the dry season, the **harmattan** – a hot dry wind from the Sahara – blows.
- Recently, at least 114 killed in the suspected jihadists attack in Burkina Faso and it is the deadliest attack since 2015.

Sahel Region

- The Sahel is the vast **semi-arid region of Africa** separating the **Sahara Desert to the north** and **tropical savannas to the south**.
- Countries in the Sahel Region - Burkina Faso, Cameroon, Chad, The Gambia, Guinea, Mauritania, Mali, Niger, Nigeria and Senegal.

Source:

<https://www.thehindu.com/news/international/dozens-killed-in-burkina-faso-in-deadliest-attack-since-2015/article34737651.ece>

Q.85) Ans: C

Exp:

- **Pair 1 is incorrect:** **Saltwater crocodile** is considered as the **Earth's largest living crocodile species**. It is found in **Odisha's Bhitarkanika National Park**, the **Sundarbans** in West Bengal and the **Andamans and Nicobar Islands**. It is also found across Southeast Asia and northern Australia. Its protection status is:
 - IUCN Red List: **Least Concern**
 - Wild Life (Protection) Act, 1972: **Schedule I**
 - CITES: **Appendix I** (except the populations of Australia, Indonesia and Papua New Guinea, which are included in Appendix II).
- **Pair 2 is correct:** **Olive Ridley turtles** are the **smallest and most abundant** of all sea turtles found in the world. They are best known for their **unique mass nesting** called **Arribada**, where thousands of females come together on the same beach to lay eggs. They are found in **warm waters of the Pacific, Atlantic and Indian oceans**. The **Odisha's Gahirmatha Marine Sanctuary** is known as the **world's largest rookery** of sea turtles. Their protection status is:
 - IUCN Red List: **Vulnerable**
 - Wildlife (Protection) Act, 1972: **Schedule I**.
 - CITES: **Appendix I**
- **Pair 3 is correct:** **Pygmy Hog** is one of the very few mammals that **build its own home, or nest**, complete with a 'roof'. It is also an **indicator species**. It thrives in **wet grassland**. Today it is mainly found in a **small population in Assam**. Its protection status is:
 - IUCN Red List: **Endangered**
 - Wildlife (Protection) Act, 1972: **Schedule I**.
 - CITES: **Appendix I**

Reference

<https://www.thehindu.com/news/national/operation-olivia-to-the-rescue-of-olive-ridleys/article34799480.ece>

Q.86) Ans: C

Exp:

- **Option A is incorrect:** The SCO is a permanent **intergovernmental international organisation**. It is a Eurasian political, economic, and security alliance and has been the **primary security pillar** of the region. It was **established** in **2001**. It was preceded by the **Shanghai Five mechanism**.



- **Option B is incorrect:** Presently SCO has **eight members**: India, Kazakhstan, China, Kyrgyzstan, Pakistan, Russia, Tajikistan, and Uzbekistan. It also has **four observer states**: Afghanistan, Belarus, Iran and Mongolia.
- **Option C is correct:** The SCO decided to admit India and Pakistan as full members at Tashkent, thereby starting the formal process of joining the SCO as full members. They became **full members** in **Astana in 2017**.

Extra Edge by OnlyIAS

About Shanghai Five Mechanism:

- The **Shanghai Five** consists of **China, Kazakhstan, Kyrgyzstan, Russia and Tajikistan**, and emerged from a series of **border demarcation and demilitarization talks** which the four former Soviet republics held with China. Since **1996**, when the group held its **first presidential summit** meeting in Shanghai, the five-country group has held annual summits ever since.

SCO has **two permanent bodies**:

- The SCO Secretariat is based in Beijing.
- The Executive Committee of the Regional Anti-Terrorist Structure (RATS) based in Tashkent.

Reference:

<https://www.thehindu.com/news/national/cabinet-gives-ex-post-facto-nod-for-signing-ratifying-sco-agreement-on-mass-media-cooperation/article34707959.ece>

Q.87) Ans: D

Exp:

Option D is correct

About Global Peace Index:

- The **Global Peace Index** is released by the **Institute for Economics & Peace (IEP)**, an international think tank. The index presents the most comprehensive analysis of **trends in peace**. It ranks countries according to their **levels of peacefulness** and identifies **potential determinants of peace**.
- The index is composed of **23 qualitative and quantitative indicators**, grouped into three key domains:

RANK	REGION	SCORE		SCORE
1	 Iceland	1.1	159	 Iraq 3.257
2	 New Zealand	1.253	160	 South Sudan 3.363
3	 Denmark	1.256	161	 Syria 3.371
4	 Portugal	1.267	162	 Yemen 3.407
5	 Slovenia	1.315	163	 Afghanistan 3.631

Top 5 countries

- Ongoing conflict
- Safety and security and
- Militarization.

Bottom 5 countries

- **Iceland** has **topped** the peace index. It was followed by New Zealand, Denmark, and Portugal. **India** has been ranked **135th in the 2021 Global Peace Index**.

Reference: OnlyIAS

<https://www.visionofhumanity.org/maps/#/>

Q.88) Ans: C

Exp:

Option C is correct

- **Bharitalasuchus tapani** is a **carnivorous reptile** that lived **240 million years ago**.
- In the mid-20th century, researchers from the Indian Statistical Institute, Kolkata, carried out extensive studies on rocks of the **Yerrapalli Formation in Telangana**, uncovering several fossils. **One of those fossils** is called **Bharitalasuchus tapani**. This reptile belonged to a **family of extinct reptiles** named **Erythrosuchidae**.



Extra Edge by OnlyIAS

- **Erythrosuchidae** (meaning red crocodiles) are a family of **large basal archosauriform carnivores**. They lived from the later **Early Triassic to the early Middle Triassic**.
- **Yerrapalli Formation** is located primarily in the **Pranhita–Godavari Basin in Telangana**. It is a **Triassic rock formation** consisting **primarily of red mudstones**. The area preserves **fossils of freshwater and terrestrial vertebrates**, as well as trace fossils of **invertebrates**.

Reference: <https://www.thehindu.com/sci-tech/science/meet-bharitalasuchus-tapani-a-carnivorous-reptile-that-lived-240-million-years-ago/article34799013.ece>

Q.89) Ans: B

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** Ministry of Jal Shakti recently released the **atlas of Glacial lakes for the Ganga river basin**. The atlas was released under the **National Hydrology Project**. **National Remote Sensing Centre (NRSC)** under ISRO carried out the hydrological studies using the satellite data and the geo-spatial technologies. In the present study, the glacial lakes with the water spread of greater than equal to 0.25 hectares were mapped. It was done using the **Resourcesat-2 Satellite**. As per the study, **Uttarakhand comprises 93% of the glacial lakes followed by Himachal Pradesh**.
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** Glacial Lakes are divided into nine different types and are grouped into four different categories. While **minimum glacial lakes are found in the Yamuna basin, the maximum glacial lakes are found in the Kosi river basin**. It is witnessed that out of the 11 subbasins, only 6 contain the glacial lakes.
- **Statement 3 is incorrect:** Lakes with area **greater than 5 hectare are around 76% of the total lake area in the basin**. More than half of the lakes are found in the high altitude regions. These lakes are dominated by the moraine dammed lakes, created with the periodic retreat of the glaciers. However, **out of the**

total lakes mapped i.e. 4,707, only 672 are greater than 5 hectares which makes just 14% of the total number of lakes in terms of the count.

Source:

<https://www.nrsc.gov.in/sites/default/files/pdf/Announcements/Glacial Lake Atlas Ganga Basin NRSC.pdf>

Q.90) Ans: A

Exp:

- **Raimona National Park** has become the **sixth national park of Assam**. It is situated in the Indo-Bhutan border along the Kokrajhar district of Assam and is bordered with the Phibsoo Wildlife Sanctuary and Jigme Singye Wangchuck National Park in Bhutan. The Golden Langur which is the mascot of the Bodoland territory of Assam forms the prime attraction of the Raimona National Park.
- **Ramgarh Vishdhari Tiger Reserve** has become the **country's 52nd Tiger Reserve and the 4th Tiger Reserve in Rajasthan**. It was created to accommodate the additional tiger population from the Ranthambore Tiger Reserve. The other three tiger reserves of the state include Ranthambore, Sariska, and Mukundra Tiger Reserve.
- **Netravali wildlife sanctuary** is situated in the state of **Goa**. It is named after the Netravali river, a tributary of the River Zuari, that originates from this sanctuary. It consists mainly of the moist deciduous vegetation.
- **Papikonda National Park** is situated in the Papi Hills of the East and the West Godavari districts of Andhra Pradesh.

Source: <https://blog.mygov.in/raimona-national-park/>

<https://newsonair.com/2021/06/23/ramgarh-vishdhari-sanctuary-rajasthan-will-soon-get-its-4th-tiger-reserve/>

Q.91) Ans: C

Exp:



- **Statement 1 is correct:** Article 41 of the Constitution says that the state shall provide within its economic capacity and development provisions for securing the right to work, education, and public assistance in case of unemployment, sickness, disablement and old age. SAGE or the Senior care Ageing Growth Engine Initiative is based on the idea of a *silver economy*. The SAGE project aims to identify, evaluate, verify, aggregate, and deliver products, solutions and services directly to the stakeholders. The Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment acts as a facilitator to this initiative. The SAGE Portal would act as the one stop access for all the services and the products required by the elderly citizens from the credible start-ups. Hence, it aims to fulfil the objectives of Article 41 of the Constitution in relation to the senior citizens
- **Statement 2 is correct:** The Surakshit Hum Surakshit Tum Abhiyan was launched by the NITI Ayog and the Piramal Foundation in the 112 aspirational districts identified by the NITI Ayog. It aims to help the district administration in providing home-care COVID-19 relief products to the mild and the asymptomatic patients. The programme is implemented by the State governments and works on the principles of **Convergence** (of the Central Sector Scheme), **Collaboration** (Central, state, and local administrators), and the **Cooperation** (among the districts).

Source:

<https://pib.gov.in/PressReleasePage.aspx?PRID=1724425>

<https://www.thehindu.com/news/national/piramal-foundation-niti-aayog-unveil-covid-home-care-drive/article34761757.ece>

Q.92) Ans: C

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is incorrect:** Goods and Services Tax or the GST is defined as a multi-stage destination based indirect tax that is levied on the consumption of goods and services. A number of central and state government taxes

have been subsumed under the GST like the VAT, Service Tax, Excise Duty, etc. However, several goods are still outside the purview of the GST for example, Custom Duty, Petroleum, Natural Gas, Diesel, Aviation turbine fuel, etc. The GST is applicable on the goods in multiple slabs like the 5%, 12%, 18%, and 28%. The tax rates are decided by the GST council, a constitutional body having representations from both the Centre as well as the States. The GST on gold is 3% and on unworked semi-precious goods, it is 0.25%, i.e., even lower than the slab of 5%.

- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** The Excise duty on the production of alcohol or liquor as well as the VAT (Value Added Tax) on the sale of the liquor is levied and collected by the State government. This tax has not been subsumed under the GST.

Q.93) Ans: B

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** Microfinance refers to the loans of small amounts provided to the smaller borrowers of the lower income group without any collateral and with a flexible repayment schedule. **Non-Banking Financial Companies- Micro-finance Institutions** is a non-deposit taking NBFC with a minimum net worth of 5 crores. They are currently regulated by the RBI as per its Comprehensive Regulatory Framework of 2011. These NBFC- MFI constitute only 30% of the total microfinance provided. As per this framework, a microfinance borrower is classified based on the annual household income into rural (Rs. 1,25,000) and the urban and semi-urban (Rs. 2,00,000).
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** The **Comprehensive Regulatory Framework 2011** of the RBI is currently applicable to the NBFC- MFIs only. However, recently RBI has proposed to develop a single framework for the regulation of all kinds of Microfinance institutions in a single framework.

Source:

<https://www.rbi.org.in/Scripts/PublicationsView.aspx>



?id=20377

<https://indianexpress.com/article/india/muhammad-yunus-nobel-prize-grameen-bank-interview-5039622/>

Q.94) Ans: B

Exp:

- The **LEAF (Lowering Emissions by Accelerating Forest Finance)** coalition is an initiative by the groups of countries, namely, Norway, USA, and UK along with the leading companies like Amazon, Nestle, etc. to mobilize finance for the protection of the tropical forests. It seeks to provide 1 billion USD finance to tropical and subtropical countries to reduce emissions and move towards deforestation. The program aims to involve all the stakeholders including the local population in the area. It would help the countries in meeting their targeted National Determined Contributions or NDCs as outlined under the Paris Agreement.

Source: <https://leafcoalition.org/>

Q.95) Ans: B

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is incorrect** : The Pradhan Mantri Awas Yojana (Urban) Programme was launched in 2015 by the Ministry of Housing and Urban Poverty Alleviation (MoHUPA), with the objective of providing pucca house to all eligible beneficiaries of Urban India by 2022 with the vision of '**Housing for All**'. The Mission seeks to address the housing requirement of urban poor including slum dwellers through following programme verticals:
 - Slum rehabilitation of Slum Dwellers with participation of private developers using land as a resource.
 - Promotion of Affordable Housing for weaker sections through credit linked subsidy.
 - Affordable Housing in Partnership with Public & Private sectors.
 - Subsidy for beneficiary-led individual house construction /enhancement.

- Its beneficiaries include **Economically weaker sections (EWS)**, **low-income groups (LIGs)** and **Middle Income Groups (MIGs)**. The annual income cap is up to Rs 3 lakh for EWS, Rs 3-6 lakh for LIG and Rs 6 + -18 lakhs for MIG.
- The EWS category of beneficiaries is eligible for assistance in all four verticals of the Missions whereas LIG and MIG categories are eligible under only the Credit linked subsidy scheme (CLSS) component of the Mission.
- **Statement 2 is correct** : Mission will be implemented as a Centrally Sponsored Scheme (CSS) except for the component of **credit linked subsidy** which will be implemented as a **Central Sector Scheme**. Recently the scheme completed 6 years.

Reference :

<https://pib.gov.in/PressReleasePage.aspx?PRID=1730005>

Q.96) Ans: B

Exp:

- At present, **Lakshadweep is under Kerala High Court's jurisdiction**. Recently, The Lakshadweep administration, which has been facing widespread protests from the islands' people over some of its policies, has mooted a proposal to shift its legal jurisdiction from the Kerala High Court to the Karnataka High Court, according to the newspaper reports.
- The **jurisdiction of a High Court can be shifted only through an Act of Parliament**, according to the law.
 - **Article 241 of the Constitution** - "Parliament may by law constitute a high court for a Union Territory or declare any court in any such territory to be a high court for all or any of the purposes of this Constitution,".
 - Section 4 of the same article mentions that "nothing in this Article derogates from the power of Parliament to extend or exclude the jurisdiction of a high court for a State to, or from, any Union Territory or part thereof".

Reference

<https://www.thehindu.com/news/national/plan-to->



put-lakshadweep-under-karnataka-high-court/article34873604.ece

Q.97) Ans: D

Exp:

- The Election Commission is a permanent and an independent body established by the Constitution of India directly to ensure free and fair elections in the country.
- **Article 324** of the Constitution provides that the power of **superintendence, direction and control of elections to parliament, state legislatures, the office of president of India and the office of vice president** of India shall be vested in the election commission.
- Article 324 of the Constitution has made the following provisions with regard to the composition of election commission:
 - The Election Commission shall consist of the chief election commissioner and such number of other election commissioners, if any, as the president may from time to time fix.
 - The appointment of the chief election commissioner and other election commissioners shall be made by the president.
 - When any other election commissioner is so appointed, the chief election commissioner shall act as the chairman of the election commission.
 - The president may also appoint regional commissioners as he may consider necessary to assist the election commission, after consultation with the **election commission.**
 - The conditions of service and tenure of office of the election commissioners and the regional commissioners shall be determined by the **president.**
- Recently, Anup Chandra Pandey has been appointed as Election Commissioner by the president.

Extra Edge by Only IAS

- From its inception in 1950 and **till 15 October 1989, the election commission functioned as a single member body** consisting of the Chief Election Commissioner. On 16 October **1989, the president appointed two more election commissioners.**
- However, the two posts of election commissioners were abolished in January 1990 and the Election Commission was reverted to the earlier position.
- Again in **October 1993, the president appointed two more election commissioners.** Since then and till today, the Election Commission has been functioning as a multi-member body consisting of three election commissioners.

Reference :

<https://www.thehindu.com/news/national/anup-chandra-pandey-takes-charge-as-election-commissioner/article34770324.ece>

Q.98) Ans: C

Exp:

Negative imports list policy

- It essentially means that the **Armed Forces—Army, Navy and Air Force—will only procure the listed items from domestic manufacturers.** The manufacturers could be private sector players or defence Public Sector Undertakings (DPSUs).
- By denying the possibility of importing the items on the negative list, the domestic industry is given the opportunity to step up and manufacture them for the needs of the forces.
- Recently, MoD notified the second defence negative import list, now called the 'Positive Indigenisation List' of 108 items, which included light helicopters with single engines, next generation Corvettes, Airborne Early Warning and Control (AEW&C) systems, mini UAV for surveillance and anti-material rifles among others.
- This is the second list issued after the government came out with a list of 101 negative import lists in August last year.



Reference :

<https://pib.gov.in/PressReleasePage.aspx?PRID=1644570>

Q.99) Ans: C

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct - Maintenance and Welfare of Parents and Senior Citizens Act, 2007** is a legislation, initiated by the Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment to provide more effective provision for maintenance and welfare of parents and senior citizens. It makes **obligations on children to maintain their parents/grandparents and also the relatives of the senior citizens to maintain such senior citizens**. The Act also has provision of punishment with imprisonment upto three months or fine of up to Rs. 5000/- or both for children or relatives, who abandon senior citizens.
- **Statement 2 is correct** - "Children" includes son, daughter, grandson and grand-daughter but does not include a minor and "maintenance" includes provision for food, clothing, residence and medical attendance and treatment, under the act. "Parent" means father or mother whether biological, adoptive or step father or step mother. This act also provides for the **setting up of old age homes** for providing maintenance to the indigent senior citizens and parents.

Reference -

<https://www.thehindu.com/news/national/karnataka/state-has-failed-in-its-obligation-to-set-up-old-age-homes-for-indigent-senior-citizens-high-court/article34703112.ece>

Q.100) Ans: D

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is Incorrect** - **H5N1** is the most common virus causing **bird flu, or avian influenza**. Though **largely restricted to birds**, and often fatal to them, it **can cross over to other animals, as well as humans**. According to the WHO, the H5N1 was first discovered in humans in 1997 and has killed almost 60% of those infected. Though it is not known to transmit easily among humans, the risk remains.
- **Statement 2 is Incorrect** - There are several subtypes of the avian influenza virus. "All known

subtypes of influenza A viruses can infect birds, except subtypes H17N10 and H18N11, which have only been found in bats. Only two influenza A virus subtypes (i.e., H1N1, and H3N2) are currently in general circulation among people. Some subtypes are found in other infected animal species. For example, H7N7 and H3N8 virus infections can cause illness in horses, and H3N8 virus infection can cause illness in horses and dogs.

- **Recently, China has confirmed the first instance of human infection from H10N3**, a rare strain of a virus that normally infects poultry.

Reference - <https://www.thehindu.com/sci-tech/health/explained-what-does-the-world-health-organisation-say-about-h10n3-bird-flu-and-is-there-a-reason-to-worry/article34741028.ece>